जब तक आपको यह परीक्षण पुस्तिका खोलने को न कहा जाए तब तक न खोलें

T.B.C.: FIAS-SFG26 **परीक्षण पुस्तिका अनुक्रम**

परीक्षण पुस्तिका

सामान्य अध्ययन

A

पूर्णांक : 102.5 **समय: एक घंटे**

अनुदेश

1. परीक्षा प्रारम्भ होने के तुरन्त बाद, आप इस परीक्षण पुस्तिका की पड़ताल अवश्य कर लें कि इसमें कोई बिना छपा, फटा या छूटा हुआ पृष्ठ अथवा प्रश्नांश, आदि न हो। यदि ऐसा है, तो इसे सही परीक्षण पुस्तिका से बदल लीजिए।
2. **कृपया ध्यान रखें कि OMR उत्तर-पत्रक में, उचित स्थान पर, रोल नम्बर और परिक्षण पुस्तिका अनुक्रम A, B, C या D को, ध्यान से एवं बिना किसी चूक या विसंगति के भरने और कूटबद्ध करने की जिम्मेदारी उम्मीदवार की है। किसी भी प्रकार की चूक/विसंगति की स्थिति में उत्तर -पत्रक निरस्त कर दिया जाएगा ।**
3. इस परीक्षण पुस्तिका पर साथ में दिए गए कोष्ठक में आपको अपना अनुक्रमांक लिखना है। परीक्षण पुस्तिका पर **और कुछ न** लिखें।

नाम:
ईमेल:
मोबाइल:

4. इस परीक्षण पुस्तिका में **60** प्रश्नांश (प्रश्न) हैं। प्रत्येक प्रश्नांश **अंग्रेज़ी और हिंदी** में छपा है। प्रत्येक प्रश्नांश में चार प्रत्युत्तर (उत्तर) दिए गए हैं। इनमें से एक प्रत्युतर को चुन लें, जिसे आप उत्तर-पत्रक पर अंकित करना चाहते हैं। यदि आपको ऐसा लगे कि एक से अधिक प्रत्युत्तर सही हैं, तो उस प्रत्युत्तर को अंकित करें जो आपको सर्वोत्तम लगे। किसी भी स्थिति में, प्रत्येक प्रश्नांश के लिए **केवल एक ही** प्रत्युत्तर चुनना है।
5. आपको अपने सभी प्रत्युत्तर अलग से दिए गए उत्तर-पत्रक पर ही अंकित करने हैं। उत्तर-पत्रक में दिए गए निर्देश देखिए।
6. **1 से 50 तक प्रत्येक 2 अंक के हैं तथा प्रश्न 51 से 60 तक प्रत्येक 0.25 अंक के हैं।**
7. इससे पहले कि आप परीक्षण पुस्तिका के विभिन्न प्रश्नांशों के प्रत्युत्तर उत्तर-पत्रक पर अंकित करना शुरू करें, आपको प्रवेश प्रमाण-पत्र के साथ प्रेषित अनुदेशों के अनुसार कुछ विवरण उत्तर-पत्रक में देने हैं।
8. आप अपने सभी प्रत्युत्तरों को उत्तर-पत्रक में भरने के बाद तथा परीक्षा के समापन पर केवल उत्तर-पत्रक अधीक्षक को सौंप दें। आपको अपने साथ परीक्षण पुस्तिका ले जाने की अनुमति है।
9. कच्चे काम के लिए पत्रक परीक्षण पुस्तिका के अंत में संलग्न है।
10. **गलत उत्तरों के लिए दंड :**

अभ्यर्थी द्वारा चिह्नित गलत उत्तरों के लिए पेनल्टी होगी, सिवाय प्रश्न 51 से 60 के, जिनमें गलत उत्तर के लिए कोई पेनल्टी नहीं है।

(i) प्रत्येक प्रश्न के लिए चार वैकल्पिक उत्तर हैं। उम्मीदवार द्वारा प्रत्येक प्रश्न के लिए दिए गए एक गलत उत्तर के लिए प्रश्न हेतु नियत किए गए अंकों का एक-तिहाई दंड के रूप में काटा जाएगा।

(ii) यदि कोई उम्मीदवार एक से अधिक उत्तर देता है, तो इसे गलत उत्तर माना जाएगा, यद्यपि दिए गए उत्तरों में से एक उत्तर सही होता है, फिर भी उस प्रश्न के लिए उपर्युक्तानुसार ही, उसी तरह का दंड दिया जाएगा।

(iii) यदि उम्मीदवार द्वारा कोई प्रश्न हल नहीं किया जाता है, अर्थात उम्मीदवार द्वारा उत्तर नहीं दिया जाता है, तो उस प्रश्न के लिए कोई दंड नहीं दिया जाएगा।

नोट: प्रश्न का उत्तर दें तथा अभ्यर्थी आत्मविश्वास स्तर (100% / 75% / 50% / 0%) का उपयोग करके उत्तर के प्रति अपनी निश्चितता का स्तर दर्ज कर सकते हैं। आप प्रत्येक प्रश्न के नीचे उपयुक्त आत्मविश्वास स्तर का चयन कर सकते हैं। इससे उन प्रश्नों की पुनरावृत्ति (रिवीजन) में सहायता मिलेगी, जिनमें उत्तर सही होने के बावजूद आप अनिश्चित थे।

जब तक आपको यह परीक्षण पुस्तिका खोलने को न कहा जाए तब तक न खोलें

Q.1) Consider the following statements in respect of the International Bank for Reconstruction and Development (IBRD):

I. It provides loans and guarantees to middle income countries.

II. It works single-handedly to help developing countries to reduce poverty.

III. It was established to help Europe rebuild after the World War II.

Which of the statements given above are correct?

a) I and II only

b) II and III only

c) I and III only

d) I, II and III

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.2) Consider the following goods:

I. Electronic Goods

II. Petroleum Products

III. Gems and Jewellery

With reference to the goods mentioned above, which of the following is the correct descending order with respect to their export value from India during FY 2024–25?

a) I - II - III

b) III - I - II

c) II - I - III

d) III - II - I

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.3) With reference to the Balance of Payments (BoP), which of the following factors can negatively affect the Current Account of a country?

I. A higher rate of inflation in the domestic country

II. A rise in national income of the country

III. Imposition of import tariffs by domestic government

IV. Depreciation of the domestic currency

Select the correct answer using the code given below:

a) I, II and III

b) I and II only

c) II, III and IV

d) I, III and IV

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.4) Which of the following best describes the primary objective of the Advance Authorisation Scheme (AAS) implemented under India's Foreign Trade Policy?

a) To provide financial subsidies to Micro, Small and Medium Enterprises (MSMEs) for establishing export-oriented production units.

b) To allow the duty-free import of inputs that are physically incorporated in products meant for export.

c) To allow exporters to obtain long-term credit from banks at concessional interest rates.

d) To provide tax rebates on profits earned by firms engaged in international trade.

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.5) What is the primary purpose of 'CROPS,' a project of the Indian Space Research Organisation (ISRO)?

a) To provide soil testing facilities to farmers in remote areas.

b) To provide satellite-enabled services, like weather forecasting, to Indian farmers.

c) To develop capabilities for growing and sustaining plants in space.

d) To enhance agricultural productivity and promote crop diversification in India.

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.1) अंतर्राष्ट्रीय पुनर्निर्माण और विकास बैंक (IBRD) के संबंध में निम्नलिखित कथनों पर विचार कीजिये:

I. यह मध्यम आय वाले देशों को ऋण और गारंटी प्रदान करता है।

II. यह विकासशील देशों को निर्धनता कम करने में सहायता करने के लिए एकल रूप से कार्य करता है।

III. इसकी स्थापना द्वितीय विश्व युद्ध के बाद यूरोप के पुनर्निर्माण में सहायता हेतु की गई थी।

उपर्युक्त कथनों में से कौन-से सही हैं?

a) केवल I और II

b) केवल II और III

c) केवल I और III

d) I, II और III

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.2) निम्नलिखित वस्तुओं पर विचार कीजिये:

I. इलेक्ट्रॉनिक वस्तुएं

II. पेट्रोलियम उत्पाद

III. रत्न एवं आभूषण

उपर्युक्त वस्तुओं के संदर्भ में, वित्तीय वर्ष 2024–25 के दौरान भारत से उनके निर्यात मूल्य के आधार पर निम्नलिखित में से कौन-सा अवरोही क्रम सही है?

a) I - II - III

b) III - I - II

c) II - I - III

d) III - II - I

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.3) भुगतान संतुलन (BoP) के संदर्भ में, निम्नलिखित में से कौन-से कारक किसी देश के चालू खाते को नकारात्मक रूप से प्रभावित कर सकते हैं?

I. देश में मुद्रास्फीति की उच्च दर

II. देश की राष्ट्रीय आय में वृद्धि

III. देश की सरकार द्वारा आयात शुल्क का अधिरोपण

IV. देश की मुद्रा का मूल्यह्रास

नीचे दिये गये कूट का प्रयोग कर सही उत्तर चुनिये:

a) I, II और III

b) केवल I और II

c) II, III और IV

d) I, III और IV

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.4) निम्नलिखित में से कौन-सा भारत की विदेश व्यापार नीति के तहत क्रियान्वित 'अग्रिम प्राधिकरण योजना' (एडवांस ऑथोराइज़ेशन स्कीम; AAS) के प्राथमिक उद्देश्य का सबसे अच्छा वर्णन करता है?

a) निर्यात-उन्मुख उत्पादन इकाइयों की स्थापना हेतु सूक्ष्म, लघु और मध्यम उद्यमों (MSMEs) को वित्तीय सब्सिडी प्रदान करना।

b) निर्यात हेतु लक्षित उत्पादों में भौतिक रूप से शामिल होने वाले आदानों (इनपुट) के शुल्क मुक्त आयात की अनुमति देना।

c) निर्यातकों को रियायती ब्याज दरों पर बैंकों से दीर्घकालिक ऋण प्राप्त करने की अनुमति देना।

d) अंतर्राष्ट्रीय व्यापार में संलग्न फर्मों द्वारा अर्जित लाभ पर कर छूट प्रदान करना।

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.5) भारतीय अंतरिक्ष अनुसंधान संगठन (ISRO) की एक परियोजना क्रॉप्स (CROPS)' का प्राथमिक उद्देश्य क्या है?

a) दूरस्थ क्षेत्रों में कृषकों को मृदा परीक्षण की सुविधा प्रदान करना।

b) भारतीय किसानों को मौसम पूर्वानुमान जैसी उपग्रह-सक्षम सेवाएं प्रदान करना।

c) अंतरिक्ष में पौधों को उगाने और उन्हें जीवित रखने की क्षमता विकसित करना।

d) भारत में कृषि उत्पादकता बढ़ाना और फसल विविधीकरण को बढ़ावा देना।

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.6) With reference to the Balance of Payments (BoP) of a country, consider the following transactions:

I. A United States of America citizen purchases bonds issued by the Government of India.
II. An Indian company receives Foreign Direct Investment (FDI) from a Japanese firm to establish a manufacturing unit in India.
III. An Indian resident receives remittances from a family member working in the United Kingdom.
IV. The Government of India repays the principal amount of external loan taken from an international financial institution.
V. An Indian software company receives payment for providing IT services to a client in Germany.

How many of the above transactions are recorded under the Capital Account of India's Balance of Payments?

a) Only two
b) Only three
c) Only four
d) All the five

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.7) In the context of maritime trade, the term Demurrage which was seen recently in news refers to:

a) The additional insurance premium paid by freight carriers while navigating through high-risk conflict zones.
b) The preferential treatment regarding port access fees given to specific countries under a regional maritime cooperation treaty.
c) The transit fee imposed by a country for allowing cargo to pass through its territory.
d) The charge paid by the merchant when cargo containers remain at the terminal beyond the permitted free time.

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.8) With reference to WTO Agreement on Trade-Related Aspects of Intellectual Property Rights (TRIPS), consider the following statements:

I. It was an outcome of the Uruguay Round of the General Agreement on Tariffs and Trade (GATT) negotiations.
II. Copyrights and related rights is one of the Intellectual Property Rights covered under the TRIPS agreement.
III. The World Intellectual Property Organization (WIPO) was established under the TRIPS Agreement.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

a) I only
b) II and III only
c) I and II only
d) I, II and III

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.9) With reference to SWIFT (The Society for Worldwide Interbank Financial Telecommunication) system, consider the following statements:

I. It is an international network developed in collaboration between the Bank for International Settlements and the International Monetary Fund (IMF).
II. All the IMF member countries are members of the SWIFT system.
III. It is a secure messaging system that helps financial institutions send payment instructions.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

a) I and II only
b) III only
c) I and III only
d) None of the above

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.6) किसी देश के भुगतान संतुलन (BoP) के संदर्भ में, निम्नलिखित विवरणों पर विचार कीजिये:

I. संयुक्त राज्य अमेरिका का एक नागरिक भारत सरकार द्वारा जारी बॉण्ड खरीदता है।

II. एक भारतीय कंपनी को भारत में विनिर्माण इकाई स्थापित करने हेतु जापानी फर्म से प्रत्यक्ष विदेशी निवेश (FDI) प्राप्त होता है।

III. एक भारतीय निवासी को यूनाइटेड किंगडम में कार्य कर रहे परिवार के सदस्य से प्रेषण (रेमिटेंस) प्राप्त होता है।

IV. भारत सरकार एक अंतर्राष्ट्रीय वित्तीय संस्थान से लिए गए बाह्य ऋण की मूल राशि चुकाती है।

V. एक भारतीय सॉफ्टवेयर कंपनी को जर्मनी में किसी क्लाइंट को IT सेवाएं प्रदान करने हेतु भुगतान प्राप्त होता है।

उपर्युक्त में से कितने विवरण भारत के भुगतान संतुलन के पूंजी खाते के अंतर्गत दर्ज किए जाते हैं?

a) केवल दो

b) केवल तीन

c) केवल चार

d) सभी पाँच

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.7) समुद्री व्यापार के संदर्भ में, हाल ही में चर्चा में रहा शब्द 'डेमरेज' (Demurrage) संदर्भित करता है:

a) उच्च जोखिम वाले संघर्ष क्षेत्रों से गुजरते समय मालवाहकों द्वारा भुगतान किया जाने वाला अतिरिक्त बीमा प्रीमियम।

b) क्षेत्रीय समुद्री सहयोग संधि के तहत विशिष्ट देशों को बंदरगाह प्रवेश शुल्क के संबंध में दी जाने वाली तरजीही व्यवस्था।

c) किसी देश द्वारा अपने क्षेत्र से माल को गुजरने की अनुमति देने के लिए लगाया जाने वाला पारगमन शुल्क।

d) जब कार्गो कंटेनर अनुमत निःशुल्क समय से अधिक समय तक टर्मिनल पर बने रहते हैं, तब व्यापारी द्वारा भुगतान किया जाने वाला शुल्क।

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.8) बौद्धिक संपदा अधिकारों के व्यापार-संबंधित पहलुओं (TRIPS) पर WTO समझौते के संदर्भ में, निम्नलिखित कथनों पर विचार कीजिये:

I. यह टैरिफ और व्यापार पर सामान्य समझौते (GATT) की उरुग्वे दौर की वार्ताओं का परिणाम था।

II. कॉपीराइट और संबंधित अधिकार TRIPS समझौते के तहत शामिल बौद्धिक संपदा अधिकारों में से एक है।

III. विश्व बौद्धिक संपदा संगठन (WIPO) की स्थापना TRIPS समझौते के तहत की गई थी।

उपर्युक्त कथनों में से कौन-सा/से सही है/हैं?

a) केवल I

b) केवल II और III

c) केवल I और II

d) I, II और III

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.9) स्विफ्ट (SWIFT; सोसाइटी फॉर वर्ल्डवाइड इंटरबैंक फाइनेंशियल टेलीकम्युनिकेशन) प्रणाली के संदर्भ में, निम्नलिखित कथनों पर विचार कीजिये:

I. यह 'बैंक फॉर इंटरनेशनल सेटलमेंट्स' (BIS) और 'अंतर्राष्ट्रीय मुद्रा कोष' (IMF) के सहयोग से विकसित एक अंतर्राष्ट्रीय नेटवर्क है।

II. सभी IMF सदस्य देश SWIFT प्रणाली के सदस्य हैं।

III. यह एक सुरक्षित संदेश प्रणाली है जो वित्तीय संस्थानों को भुगतान निर्देश भेजने में सहायता करती है।

उपर्युक्त कथनों में से कौन-सा/से सही है/हैं?

a) केवल I और II

b) केवल III

c) केवल I और III

d) उपर्युक्त में से कोई नहीं

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.10) Which of the following statements correctly describes the Global Plastic Action Partnership (GPAP)?

a) It is an initiative of the World Economic Forum, that aimed at combating plastic pollution worldwide.
b) It is a flagship initiative of the United Nations Environment Programme, that aims to reduce plastic pollution.
c) It is a partnership between the World Wide Fund for Nature and the International Union for Conservation of Nature that works to combat marine plastic pollution.
d) It is a global commitment led by the Ellen MacArthur Foundation, that unites businesses, governments, NGOs, and investors.

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.11) Which one of the following would be considered as Foreign Direct Investment?

a) A foreign company buying shares in stock exchanges in India
b) A foreign country pension fund investing in Indian stock markets
c) A foreign merchant banker buying shares from Indian stock markets
d) A foreign entity setting up an educational institution in India

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.12) With reference to the Foreign Direct Investment (FDI) into India, consider the following states:

I. Maharashtra
II. Gujarat
III. Karnataka
IV. Tamil Nadu

Which one of the following correctly represents the descending order of overall FDI equity inflows in the state given above in FY 2024-25?

a) I – II – III – IV
b) I – III – II – IV
c) II – I – III – IV
d) I – II – IV – III

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.13) In the context of the Indian Economy, which of the following institutions function under the Ministry of Commerce?

I. Export Credit Guarantee Corporation of India
II. Agricultural and Processed Food Products Export Development Authority (APEDA)
III. Marine Products Export Development Authority

Select the correct answer using the code given below:

a) I and II only
b) I and III only
c) II and III only
d) I, II and III

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.14) Consider the following statements:

The net exports are also termed as the trade balance, is the net sum of a country's exports and imports in:

I. goods
II. services

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

a) I only
b) II only
c) Both I and II
d) neither I nor II

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.15) Operation Sindhu, which was in the news recently, refers to:

a) A mission to evacuate Indian nationals from conflict zones in Iran.
b) A naval exercise between India and Southeast Asian nations in the South China Sea.
c) A disaster relief operation in response to a major earthquake in Central Asia.
d) An initiative to promote sustainable fishing practices in the Indian Ocean.

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.10) निम्नलिखित में से कौन-सा कथन 'ग्लोबल प्लास्टिक एक्शन पार्टनरशिप' (GPAP) का सही वर्णन करता है?

a) यह विश्व आर्थिक मंच की एक पहल है, जिसका उद्देश्य विश्व भर में प्लास्टिक प्रदूषण का मुकाबला करना है।

b) यह संयुक्त राष्ट्र पर्यावरण कार्यक्रम की एक प्रमुख पहल है, जिसका उद्देश्य प्लास्टिक प्रदूषण को कम करना है।

c) यह वर्ल्ड वाइड फंड फॉर नेचर और प्रकृति संरक्षण के लिए अंतर्राष्ट्रीय संघ (IUCN) के बीच एक साझेदारी है जो समुद्री प्लास्टिक प्रदूषण से निपटने हेतु कार्य करती है।

d) यह एलेन मैकआर्थर फाउंडेशन के नेतृत्व में एक वैश्विक प्रतिबद्धता है, जो व्यवसायों, सरकारों, गैर सरकारी संगठनों (NGOs) और निवेशकों को एकजुट करती है।

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.11) निम्नलिखित में से किसे प्रत्यक्ष विदेशी निवेश (FDI) माना जाएगा?

a) भारत में स्टॉक एक्सचेंजों में शेयर खरीदने वाली कोई विदेशी कंपनी

b) भारतीय शेयर बाजारों में निवेश करने वाला किसी विदेशी राष्ट्र का पेंशन फंड

c) भारतीय शेयर बाजारों से शेयर खरीदने वाला कोई विदेशी मर्चेंट बैंकर

d) भारत में एक शैक्षणिक संस्थान स्थापित करने वाली कोई विदेशी इकाई

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.12) भारत में प्रत्यक्ष विदेशी निवेश (FDI) के संदर्भ में, निम्नलिखित राज्यों पर विचार कीजिये:

I. महाराष्ट्र

II. गुजरात

III. कर्नाटक

IV. तमिलनाडु

निम्नलिखित में से कौन-सा विकल्प वित्तीय वर्ष 2024–25 में उपर्युक्त राज्यों में कुल FDI इक्विटी प्रवाह के अवरोही क्रम को सही रूप में दर्शाता है?

a) I – II – III – IV

b) I – III – II – IV

c) II – I – III – IV

d) I – II – IV – III

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.13) भारतीय अर्थव्यवस्था के संदर्भ में, निम्नलिखित में से कौन-से संस्थान वाणिज्य मंत्रालय के अधीन कार्य करते हैं?

I. भारतीय निर्यात ऋण गारंटी निगम (ECGC)

II. कृषि और प्रसंस्कृत खाद्य उत्पाद निर्यात विकास प्राधिकरण (APEDA)

III. समुद्री उत्पाद निर्यात विकास प्राधिकरण (MPEDA)

नीचे दिए गए कूट का उपयोग करके सही उत्तर चुनिए:

a) केवल I और II

b) केवल I और III

c) केवल II और III

d) I, II और III

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.14) निम्नलिखित कथनों पर विचार कीजिये:

शुद्ध निर्यात को व्यापार संतुलन भी कहा जाता है, जो किसी देश के निम्नलिखित में निर्यात और आयात का शुद्ध योग है:

I. वस्तुएं

II. सेवाएं

उपर्युक्त कथनों में से कौन-सा/से सही है/हैं?

a) केवल I

b) केवल II

c) I और II दोनों

d) न तो I और न ही II

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.15) हाल ही में चर्चा में रहा 'ऑपरेशन सिंधु' संदर्भित करता है:

a) ईरान के संघर्ष-प्रभावित क्षेत्रों से भारतीय नागरिकों को निकालने का एक मिशन।

b) दक्षिण चीन सागर में भारत और दक्षिण-पूर्व एशियाई देशों के बीच एक नौसैनिक अभ्यास।

c) मध्य एशिया में आए एक बड़े भूकंप के प्रत्युत्तर में एक आपदा राहत अभियान।

d) हिंद महासागर में सतत मत्स्यन प्रथाओं को बढ़ावा देने हेतु एक पहल।

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.16) In the context of Indian Economy, the Net International Investment Position (NIIP) will be negative when:

a) India's total foreign liabilities exceed its total foreign assets.
b) India's total Foreign Direct Investment outflows exceed the Foreign Direct Investment inflows it receives.
c) India's net current account balance exceeds the capital account balance.
d) India's net inflow of Foreign Portfolio investment exceeds the net inflow of Foreign Direct Investment.

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.17) Consider the following statements:
An increase in Nominal Effective Exchange Rate of the country indicates:

I. the appreciation of domestic currency against its major trading partners.
II. an improvement in trade competitiveness of the country.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

a) I only
b) II only
c) Both I and II
d) Neither I nor II

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.18) Consider the following statements:

I. Purchasing Power Parity exchange rate is the rate at which the currency of one country would have to be converted into that of another country to buy the same amount of goods and services in each country
II. India is the third-largest economy in the world in terms of GDP based on purchasing power parity (PPP).

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

a) I only
b) II only
c) Both I and II
d) Neither I nor II

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.19) Consider the following statements with reference to the International Finance Corporation:

I. Globally, India has the highest investment portfolio exposure of the International Finance Corporation (IFC).
II. Being the private arm of the World Bank, it can lend directly to micro, small, and medium enterprises or individual entrepreneurs.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

a) I only
b) II only
c) Both I and II
d) Neither I nor II

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.20) The Wildlife Institute of India conducted the first-ever comprehensive population estimation of riverine dolphins in India. Which of the following is/are correct regarding the findings of this survey?

I. Uttar Pradesh has the highest number of Gangetic Dolphins among all the States in India.
II. The population density of Gangetic Dolphins is highest in Yamuna River.
III. Sutlej is the only river in India in which Indus River Dolphins were found.

Select the correct answer using the code given below:

a) I only
b) I and II
c) III only
d) I and III

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.16) भारतीय अर्थव्यवस्था के संदर्भ में, शुद्ध अंतर्राष्ट्रीय निवेश स्थिति (NIIP) ऋणात्मक होगी जब:

a) जब भारत की कुल विदेशी देनदारियाँ उसकी कुल विदेशी परिसंपत्तियों से अधिक हों।

b) जब भारत के कुल प्रत्यक्ष विदेशी निवेश (FDI) के बहिर्प्रवाह उसे प्राप्त होने वाले प्रत्यक्ष विदेशी निवेश (FDI) के अंतःप्रवाह से अधिक हों।

c) जब भारत का शुद्ध चालू खाता संतुलन पूंजी खाते के संतुलन से अधिक हो।

d) जब भारत में विदेशी पोर्टफोलियो निवेश (FPI) का शुद्ध अंतःप्रवाह प्रत्यक्ष विदेशी निवेश (FDI) के शुद्ध अंतःप्रवाह से अधिक हो।

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.17) निम्नलिखित कथनों पर विचार कीजिए:

किसी देश की नाममात्र प्रभावी विनिमय दर में वृद्धि इंगित करती है:

I. प्रमुख व्यापारिक साझेदारों के मुकाबले घरेलू मुद्रा की मूल्यवृद्धि।

II. देश की व्यापारिक प्रतिस्पर्धात्मकता में सुधार।

उपर्युक्त कथनों में से कौन सा/से सही है/हैं?

a) केवल I

b) केवल II

c) I और II दोनों

d) न तो I और न ही II

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.18) निम्नलिखित कथनों पर विचार कीजिए:

I. क्रय शक्ति समता विनिमय दर वह दर है जिस पर एक देश की मुद्रा को दूसरे देश की मुद्रा में परिवर्तित करने पर दोनों देशों में समान मात्रा में वस्तुएँ और सेवाएं खरीदी जा सकती हैं।

II. क्रय शक्ति समता (PPP) के आधार पर सकल घरेलू उत्पाद (GDP) के मामले में भारत विश्व की तीसरी सबसे बड़ी अर्थव्यवस्था है।

उपर्युक्त कथनों में से कौन सा/से सही है/हैं?

a) केवल I

b) केवल II

c) I और II दोनों

d) न तो I और न ही II

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.19) अंतर्राष्ट्रीय वित्त निगम के संदर्भ में निम्नलिखित कथनों पर विचार कीजिए:

I. वैश्विक स्तर पर, अंतर्राष्ट्रीय वित्त निगम (IFC) में भारत का निवेश पोर्टफोलियो सबसे अधिक है।

II. विश्व बैंक की निजी शाखा होने के नाते, यह सूक्ष्म, लघु और मध्यम उद्यमों या व्यक्तिगत उद्यमियों को सीधे ऋण दे सकता है।

उपर्युक्त कथनों में से कौन सा/से सही है/हैं?

a) केवल I

b) केवल II

c) I और II दोनों

d) न तो I और न ही II

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.20) भारतीय वन्यजीव संस्थान ने भारत में नदी डॉल्फिन की पहली व्यापक जनसंख्या गणना की। इस सर्वेक्षण के निष्कर्षों के संबंध में निम्नलिखित में से कौन सा/से कथन सही है/हैं?

I. भारत के सभी राज्यों में उत्तर प्रदेश में गंगा डॉल्फिन की संख्या सबसे अधिक है।

II. गंगा डॉल्फिन का जनसंख्या घनत्व यमुना नदी में सबसे अधिक है।

III. सतलुज भारत की एकमात्र नदी है जिसमें सिंधु नदी डॉल्फिन पाई गई हैं।

नीचे दिए गए कूट का उपयोग करके सही उत्तर चुनिए:

a) केवल I

b) I और II

c) केवल III

d) I और III

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.21) Consider the following statements:

1. India is a member of the International Grains Council.
2. A country needs to be a member of the International Grains Council for exporting or importing rice and wheat.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

a) 1 only
b) 2 only
c) Both 1 and 2
d) Neither 1 nor 2

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.22) Which of the following factors may lead to appreciation of the Indian rupee?

I. Reserve Bank of India selling US Dollars in the domestic market.
II. Foreign investors pulling out funds from Indian markets.
III. Increase in investments in masala bonds which is a rupee denominated bond issued outside India.
IV. Lower inflation in India compared to other countries.

Select the correct answer using the code given below:

a) I and IV only
b) II and III only
c) I, III and IV only
d) I, II, III and IV

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.23) The Asia Power Index, an index that distinguishes between resources (what countries possess) and influence (how effectively those resources are translated into regional outcomes) is published/released by:

a) Asian Development Bank
b) World Economic Forum
c) Lowy Institute
d) The Institute of South Asian Studies

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.24) It is an economic concept that reflects the conflict between the short-term domestic policies and long-term international responsibility for countries whose currencies serve as global reserve currencies.

Which of the following dilemmas/paradox have been explained above?

a) Lucas paradox
b) Bertrand paradox
c) Triffin paradox or dilemma
d) Leontief paradox

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.25) With reference to the cultivation of genetically modified crops in India, consider the following statements:

Statement I: In the recent past, there has been an increasing demand for the Bollgard-3 variety of cotton by farmers of Punjab.

Statement II: The use of the Bollgard-3 variety for cotton cultivation in some of the other States in India have shown remarkable success.

Statements III: Bollgard-3 is a pest-resistant genetically-modified (GM) variety of cotton that shows remarkable resistance to pests.

Which one of the following is correct in respect of the statements given above?

a) Both statement II and statement III are correct and both of them explain statement I.
b) Both statement II and statement III are correct, but only one of them explains statement I.
c) Only one of the statements II and III is correct, and that explains statement I.
d) Neither Statement II nor statement III is correct.

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.21) निम्नलिखित कथनों पर विचार कीजिए:

1. भारत इंटरनेशनल ग्रेन्स काउंसिल का सदस्य है।
2. चावल और गेहूं के निर्यात या आयात के लिए किसी देश को इंटरनेशनल ग्रेन्स काउंसिल का सदस्य होना आवश्यक है।

उपर्युक्त कथनों में से कौन सा/से सही है/हैं?

a) केवल 1

b) केवल 2

c) 1 और 2 दोनों

d) न तो 1 और न ही 2

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.22) निम्नलिखित में से कौन से कारक भारतीय रुपये के मूल्य में वृद्धि का कारण बन सकते हैं?

I. भारतीय रिजर्व बैंक द्वारा घरेलू बाजार में अमेरिकी डॉलर की बिक्री।

II. विदेशी निवेशकों द्वारा भारतीय बाजारों से धन की निकासी।

III. मसाला बांडों में निवेश में वृद्धि, जो भारत के बाहर जारी किए गए रुपये मूल्यवर्ग के बांड हैं।

IV. अन्य देशों की तुलना में भारत में कम मुद्रास्फीति।

नीचे दिए गए कूट का उपयोग करके सही उत्तर चुनिए:

a) केवल I और IV

b) केवल II और III

c) केवल I, III और IV

d) I, II, III और IV

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.23) एशिया पावर इंडेक्स, जो संसाधनों (देशों के पास मौजूद संसाधन) और प्रभाव (उन संसाधनों को क्षेत्रीय परिणामों में कितनी प्रभावी ढंग से परिवर्तित किया जाता है) के बीच अंतर करता है, किसके द्वारा प्रकाशित/जारी किया जाता है?

a) एशियाई विकास बैंक

b) विश्व आर्थिक मंच

c) लोवी इंस्टीट्यूट

d) दक्षिण एशियाई अध्ययन संस्थान

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.24) यह एक आर्थिक अवधारणा है जो उन देशों की अल्पकालिक घरेलू नीतियों और दीर्घकालिक अंतरराष्ट्रीय जिम्मेदारी के बीच संघर्ष को दर्शाती है जिनकी मुद्राएँ वैश्विक आरक्षित मुद्राओं के रूप में कार्य करती हैं।

निम्नलिखित में से कौन सी दुविधा / विरोधाभास ऊपर वर्णित है?

a) लुकास विरोधाभास

b) बर्ट्रेंड विरोधाभास

c) ट्रिफिन विरोधाभास या दुविधा

d) लियोन्टिफ विरोधाभास

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.25) भारत में आनुवंशिक रूप से संशोधित फसलों की खेती के संदर्भ में, निम्नलिखित कथनों पर विचार कीजिए:

कथन I: हाल के दिनों में, पंजाब के किसानों द्वारा बोलगार्ड-3 किस्म की कपास की मांग में वृद्धि हुई है।

कथन II: भारत के कुछ अन्य राज्यों में कपास की खेती के लिए बोलगार्ड-3 किस्म के उपयोग ने उल्लेखनीय सफलता दिखाई है।

कथन III: बोलगार्ड-3 कपास की एक कीट-प्रतिरोधी आनुवंशिक रूप से संशोधित (GM) किस्म है जो कीटों के प्रति उल्लेखनीय प्रतिरोध दिखाती है।

उपर्युक्त कथनों के संबंध में निम्नलिखित में से कौन सा कथन सही है?

a) कथन II और कथन III दोनों सही हैं और दोनों ही कथन I की व्याख्या करते हैं।

b) कथन II और कथन III दोनों सही हैं, लेकिन उनमें से केवल एक ही कथन I की व्याख्या करता है।

c) कथन II और III में से केवल एक ही सही है, और वह कथन I की व्याख्या करता है।

d) न तो कथन II और न ही कथन III सही है।

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.26) With reference to Trade Related Investment Measures (TRIMS), which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. Quantitative restrictions on imports by foreign investors are prohibited.
2. They apply to investment measures related to trade in both goods and services.
3. They are not concerned with the regulation of foreign investment.

Select the correct answer using the code given below:

a) 1 and 2 only
b) 2 only
c) 1 and 3 only
d) 1, 2 and 3

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.27) With reference to Eligible Manufacturer Importers (EMIs) Scheme, consider the following statements:

I. It was launched by the Central Board of Indirect Taxes and Customs.
II. Under it, Eligible Manufacturer Importers will be able to clear imported goods without paying Customs duty at the time of clearance.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

a) I only
b) II only
c) Both I and II
d) Neither I nor II

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.28) In which of the following sectors, 100 percent foreign direct investment under automatic route is permitted in India?

I. Insurance Company
II. Marketplace model of e-commerce
III. Private Sector Banks
IV. Coal mining

Select the correct answer using the code given below:

a) I, II and III
b) I, II and IV
c) II and IV only
d) I, III and IV

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.29) Consider the following statements with reference to the Asian Infrastructure Investment Bank (AIIB):

I. India is the second-largest shareholder in the bank.
II. India is the largest borrower country from the bank in terms of total loan value.
III. Membership in the bank is open only to countries located in Asia.

Which of the statements given above are correct?

a) I and III only
b) II and III only
c) I and II only
d) I, II and III

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.30) Which of the following statements is/are correct with respect to GARBH-INi-DRISHTI that was recently seen in the news?

I. It is an initiative of the Ministry of Health and Family Welfare of the Government of India.
II. It is an antenatal care facility for pregnant women that focuses on adequate physical and emotional development.

Select the correct answer using the code given below

a) I only
b) II only
c) Both I and II
d) Neither I nor II

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.31) "Gold Tranche" (Reserve Tranche) refers to

a) a loan system of the World Bank
b) one of the operations of a Central Bank
c) a credit system granted by WTO to its members
d) a credit system granted by IMF to its members

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.26) व्यापार संबंधित निवेश उपायों (TRIMS) के संदर्भ में, निम्नलिखित में से कौन सा/से कथन सही है/हैं?

1. विदेशी निवेशकों द्वारा आयात पर मात्रात्मक प्रतिबंध निषिद्ध हैं।
2. ये वस्तुओं और सेवाओं दोनों के व्यापार से संबंधित निवेश उपायों पर लागू होते हैं।
3. इनका विदेशी निवेश के विनियमन से कोई संबंध नहीं है।

नीचे दिए गए कूट का उपयोग करके सही उत्तर चुनिए:

a) केवल 1 और 2
b) केवल 2
c) केवल 1 और 3
d) 1, 2 और 3

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.27) पात्र विनिर्माता आयातक (EMIs) योजना के संदर्भ में, निम्नलिखित कथनों पर विचार कीजिए:

I. इसे केंद्रीय अप्रत्यक्ष कर एवं सीमा शुल्क बोर्ड द्वारा शुरू किया गया था।
II. इसके तहत, पात्र विनिर्माता आयातकों को माल की निकासी के समय सीमा शुल्क का भुगतान किए बिना आयातित माल की निकासी की सुविधा मिलेगी।

उपर्युक्त कथनों में से कौन सा/से सही है/हैं?

a) केवल I
b) केवल II
c) I और II दोनों
d) न तो I और न ही II

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.28) भारत में निम्नलिखित में से किस क्षेत्र में स्वचालित मार्ग के तहत 100 प्रतिशत प्रत्यक्ष विदेशी निवेश की अनुमति है?

I. बीमा कंपनी
II. ई-कॉमर्स का मार्केटप्लेस मॉडल
III. निजी क्षेत्र के बैंक
IV. कोयला खनन

नीचे दिए गए कूट का उपयोग करके सही उत्तर चुनिए:

a) I, II और III
b) I, II और IV
c) केवल II और IV
d) I, III और IV

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.29) एशियाई अवसंरचना निवेश बैंक (AIIB) के संदर्भ में निम्नलिखित कथनों पर विचार कीजिए:

I. भारत इस बैंक में दूसरा सबसे बड़ा शेयरधारक है।
II. कुल ऋण राशि के संदर्भ में भारत इस बैंक से सबसे अधिक ऋण प्राप्त करने वाला देश है।
III. इस बैंक की सदस्यता केवल एशिया में स्थित देशों तक सीमित है।

उपर्युक्त कथनों में से कौन से सही हैं?

a) केवल I और III
b) केवल II और III
c) केवल I और II
d) I, II और III

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.30) हाल ही में खबरों में आई 'गर्भ-इन-दृष्टि'(GARBH-INi-DRISHTI) के संबंध में निम्नलिखित में से कौन सा/से कथन सही है/हैं?

I. यह भारत सरकार के स्वास्थ्य एवं परिवार कल्याण मंत्रालय की एक पहल है।
II. यह गर्भवती महिलाओं के लिए एक प्रसवपूर्व देखभाल सुविधा है जो पर्याप्त शारीरिक और भावनात्मक विकास पर ध्यान केंद्रित करती है।

नीचे दिए गए कूट का उपयोग करके सही उत्तर चुनें।

a) केवल I
b) केवल II
c) I और II दोनों
d) न तो I और न ही II

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.31) "स्वर्ण-ट्रान्श" (रिज़र्व ट्रान्श) निर्दिष्ट करता है

a) विश्व बैंक की ऋण व्यवस्था
b) केन्द्रीय बैंक की किसी एक क्रिया को
c) WTO द्वारा इसके सदस्यों को प्रदत्त एक साख प्रणाली को
d) IMF द्वारा इसके सदस्यों को प्रदत्त एक साख प्रणाली को

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.32) Consider the following regional economic groupings:

I. Indo-Pacific Economic Framework (IPEF)
II. Asia-Pacific Economic Cooperation (APEC)
III. Regional Comprehensive Economic Partnership (RCEP)

In how many of the above groupings, India is a member?

a) Only one
b) Only two
c) All the three
d) None

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.33) Which one of the following best describes the primary function of the Paris Club or Club de Paris?

a) Formulating standards for stablecoins used in international transactions.
b) Supporting encrypted messaging services for financial transactions.
c) Promoting a borderless trade regime among countries.
d) Coordinating debt relief and restructuring for countries facing financial difficulties.

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.34) With reference to Minerals Security Partnership, consider the following statements:

I. It is an initiative launched by the United States of America.
II. The Minerals Security Finance Network has been established under it to facilitate financing for critical mineral supply chains.
III. India is a member of the Minerals Security Partnership.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

a) I and II only
b) III only
c) I and III only
d) I, II and III

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.35) The Defence Research and Development Organisation (DRDO) recently demonstrated a cutting-edge "active cooled scramjet combustor ground test" for 120 seconds for the first time in India. In this context, consider the following statements regarding the Scramjet Technology:

I. Unlike traditional rocket engines, Scramjet engines do not use oxygen from the atmosphere for combustion of fuels.
II. Unlike conventional jet engines, Scramjet engines do not have any rotating compressors.
III. Scramjet engines can work efficiently at hypersonic speeds.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

a) III only
b) II only
c) II and III only
d) I, II and III

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.36) Consider the following reports:

I. Global Estimates on International Migrant Workers
II. World Economic Situation and Prospects Report
III. The Future of Jobs Report
IV. The Global Cybersecurity Outlook

How many of the reports given above are released by the World Economic Forum?

a) Only one
b) Only two
c) Only three
d) All the four

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.32) निम्नलिखित क्षेत्रीय आर्थिक समूहों पर विचार कीजिए:

I. हिन्द-प्रशांत आर्थिक ढाँचा (IPEF)

II. एशिया-प्रशांत आर्थिक सहयोग (APEC)

III. क्षेत्रीय व्यापक आर्थिक साझेदारी (RCEP)

उपर्युक्त में से कितने समूहों में भारत सदस्य है?

a) केवल एक

b) केवल दो

c) सभी तीन

d) कोई नहीं

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.33) निम्नलिखित में से कौन-सा विकल्प पेरिस क्लब के मुख्य कार्य का सर्वोत्तम वर्णन करता है?

a) अंतर्राष्ट्रीय लेन-देन में उपयोग किए जाने वाले स्टेबलकॉइन के लिए मानक निर्धारित करना

b) वित्तीय लेन-देन के लिए कूटबद्ध (एन्क्रिप्टेड) संदेश सेवाओं को समर्थन देना

c) देशों के बीच सीमाहीन व्यापार व्यवस्था को बढ़ावा देना

d) वित्तीय कठिनाइयों का सामना कर रहे देशों के लिए ऋण राहत और ऋण पुनर्गठन का समन्वय करना

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.34) खनिज सुरक्षा भागीदारी के संदर्भ में निम्नलिखित कथनों पर विचार कीजिए:

I. यह संयुक्त राज्य अमेरिका के नेतृत्व में प्रारम्भ की गई पहल है।

II. इसके अंतर्गत महत्वपूर्ण खनिज आपूर्ति श्रृंखलाओं के वित्तपोषण को सुगम बनाने के लिए एक वित्तीय नेटवर्क की स्थापना की गई है।

III. भारत इस खनिज सुरक्षा भागीदारी का सदस्य है।

उपर्युक्त कथनों में से कौन-सा/से सही है/हैं?

a) केवल I और II

b) केवल III

c) केवल I और III

d) I, II और III

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.35) रक्षा अनुसंधान एवं विकास संगठन (DRDO) ने हाल ही में भारत में पहली बार 120 सेकंड के लिए अत्याधुनिक "एक्टिव कूल्ड स्क्रैमजेट कम्बस्टर ग्राउंड टेस्ट" का सफल प्रदर्शन किया। इस संदर्भ में स्क्रैमजेट प्रौद्योगिकी (Scramjet Technology) के संबंध में निम्नलिखित कथनों पर विचार कीजिए:

I. पारंपरिक रॉकेट इंजनों के विपरीत, स्क्रैमजेट इंजन ईंधन के दहन के लिए वायुमंडल से ऑक्सीजन का उपयोग नहीं करते।

II. परंपरागत जेट इंजनों के विपरीत, स्क्रैमजेट इंजनों में कोई घूर्णनशील कंप्रेसर नहीं होता।

III. स्क्रैमजेट इंजन हाइपरसोनिक गति पर प्रभावी रूप से कार्य कर सकते हैं।

उपर्युक्त कथनों में से कौन सा/से सही है/हैं?

a) केवल III

b) केवल II

c) केवल II और III

d) I, II और III

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.36) निम्नलिखित रिपोर्ट पर विचार कीजिए:

I. अंतरराष्ट्रीय प्रवासी श्रमिकों पर वैश्विक अनुमान

II. विश्व आर्थिक स्थिति और संभावनाएं रिपोर्ट

III. फ्यूचर ऑफ जॉब्स रिपोर्ट

IV. वैश्विक साइबर सुरक्षा आउटलुक

उपर्युक्त में से कितनी रिपोर्ट विश्व आर्थिक मंच द्वारा जारी की जाती हैं?

a) केवल एक

b) केवल दो

c) केवल तीन

d) सभी चार

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.37) With reference to the India-European Union (EU) Free Trade Agreement, consider the following statements:

I. The agreement provides the EU with immediate duty elimination for over 97% of its total export value to the India market.

II. The EU has excluded items such as sugar and tobacco from tariff concessions.

III. The trade deal requires India and the EU to have the same labour and environmental laws.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

a) I and II only

b) II only

c) I and III only

d) None of the above

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.38) With reference to International Monetary Fund, consider the following statements:

I. It facilitates the expansion of international trade and economic growth.

II. More than 75% of its funds comes through Bilateral Borrowing Agreements (BBAs) with the member countries.

III. Global Financial Stability Report is published by IMF.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

a) I and II

b) II only

c) II and III

d) I and III

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.39) With reference to core/fundamental International Labour Organisation (ILO) Conventions, consider the following:

I. Freedom of Association and Protection of the Right to Organise Convention, 1948 (No. 87)

II. Worst Forms of Child Labour Convention, 1999 (No. 182)

III. Minimum Age Convention, 1973 (No. 138)

IV. Right to Organise and Collective Bargaining Convention, 1949 (No.98)

Which of the above ILO conventions have been ratified by India?

a) I and IV only

b) II and III only

c) I, II and III only

d) I, II, III and IV

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.40) The 'Blue Line' is a border demarcation frequently discussed in the context of:

a) Israel and Jordan

b) Israel and Lebanon

c) Egypt and Sudan

d) Syria and Turkey

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.41) Which of the following statements are correct about the composition of the G-20?

1. All G-7 countries are members of G-20
2. All BRICS countries are members of G-20
3. All ASEAN countries are members of G-20
4. All permanent members of Security Council are members of G-20

Select the answer using the code given below:

a) 1, 2 and 3

b) 2 and 4 only

c) 1 and 4

d) 2, 3 and 4

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.37) भारत–यूरोपीय संघ मुक्त व्यापार समझौते के संदर्भ में निम्नलिखित कथनों पर विचार कीजिए:

I. यह समझौता यूरोपीय संघ को भारत के बाजार में अपने कुल निर्यात मूल्य के 97% से अधिक पर तत्काल शुल्क छूट प्रदान करता है।

II. यूरोपीय संघ ने चीनी और तंबाकू जैसे उत्पादों को शुल्क रियायतों से बाहर रखा है।

III. व्यापार समझौते के तहत भारत और यूरोपीय संघ को समान श्रम और पर्यावरण कानून अपनाने होंगे।

उपर्युक्त कथनों में से कौन सा/से कथन सही है/हैं?

a) केवल I और II

b) केवल II

c) केवल I और III

d) उपर्युक्त में से कोई नहीं

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.38) अंतरराष्ट्रीय मुद्रा कोष के संदर्भ में निम्नलिखित कथनों पर विचार कीजिए:

I. यह अंतरराष्ट्रीय व्यापार और आर्थिक विकास के विस्तार को प्रोत्साहित करता है।

II. इसके 75% से अधिक वित्तीय संसाधन सदस्य देशों के साथ द्विपक्षीय उधार समझौतों (BBAs) से प्राप्त होते हैं।

III. वैश्विक वित्तीय स्थिरता रिपोर्ट अंतरराष्ट्रीय मुद्रा कोष द्वारा प्रकाशित की जाती है।

उपर्युक्त कथनों में से कौन-सा/से सही है/हैं?

a) I और II

b) केवल II

c) II और III

d) I और III

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.39) अंतरराष्ट्रीय श्रम संगठन की मूलभूत संधियों के संदर्भ में निम्नलिखित पर विचार कीजिए:

I. संघ की स्वतंत्रता और संगठित होने के अधिकार का संरक्षण सम्मेलन (1948)

II. बाल श्रम के सबसे खराब रूपों के उन्मूलन का सम्मेलन, 1999 (संख्या 182)

III. न्यूनतम आयु सम्मेलन, 1973 (संख्या 138)

IV. संगठित होने तथा सामूहिक सौदेबाजी पर सम्मेलन, 1949 (संख्या 98)

उपर्युक्त में से कौन-सी संधियाँ भारत द्वारा अनुमोदित की गई हैं?

a) केवल I और IV

b) केवल II और III

c) केवल I, II और III

d) I, II, III और IV

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.40) 'ब्लू लाइन' सीमा-रेखा का उल्लेख प्रायः निम्नलिखित में से किन देशों के संदर्भ में किया जाता है?

a) इजरायल और जॉर्डन

b) इजरायल और लेबनान

c) मिस्र और सूडान

d) सीरिया और तुर्की

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.41) G-20 की संरचना के संबंध में निम्नलिखित कथनों पर विचार कीजिए:

1. G-7 के सभी देश G-20 के सदस्य हैं।
2. ब्रिक्स के सभी देश G-20 के सदस्य हैं।
3. आसियान के सभी देश G-20 के सदस्य हैं।
4. संयुक्त राष्ट्र सुरक्षा परिषद के सभी स्थायी सदस्य G-20 के सदस्य हैं।

नीचे दिए गए कूट का प्रयोग कर सही उत्तर चुनिए:

a) 1, 2 और 3

b) केवल 2 और 4

c) 1 और 4

d) 2, 3 और 4

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.42) With reference to World Trade Organization, consider the following statements about Most Favored Nation principle:

Statement I: A Free Trade Agreement (FTA) between two countries is considered a violation of the Most Favored Nation principle.

Statement II: The Most Favored Nation principle requires a member country to treat all other WTO members equally in matters of trade concessions.

Which one of the following is correct in respect of the above statements?

a) Both Statement I and Statement II are correct and Statement II explains Statement I

b) Both Statement I and Statement II are correct but Statement II does not explain Statement I

c) Statement I is correct but Statement II is not correct

d) Statement I is not correct but Statement II is correct

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.43) In the context of Indian Economy, consider the following statements:

I. The Sovereign External Debt accounts for about 77 per cent of India's total external debt.

II. In terms of maturity, the long-term external debt constitutes around 80 per cent of the total external debt

III. In terms of the denomination of external debt, the Indian Rupee continued to be the largest component of India's external debt

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

a) II and III only

b) II only

c) I, II and III

d) I and III only

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.44) With reference to global infrastructure initiatives, consider the following pairs:

International infrastructure initiatives	**Launched by**
I. Blue Dot Network	Russia
II. Global Gateway Initiative	China
III. Partnership for Global Infrastructure and Investment	India

How many of the above pairs are correctly matched?

a) Only one

b) Only two

c) All the three

d) None

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.45) The Government of India has recently announced the creation of a new National Gene Bank. In this context which of the statements given below is correct?

a) It would be the first ever Gene Bank to be created in India.

b) This Gene Bank would conserve about 10 lakh crop germplasm for future food and nutritional security in India.

c) It will be one of the initiatives under the theme "One Day One Genome" of the Union Budget 2025-26.

d) It will be established and managed by the National Biodiversity Authority.

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.42) विश्व व्यापार संगठन के संदर्भ में मोस्ट फेवर्ड नेशन सिद्धांत के बारे में निम्नलिखित कथनों पर विचार कीजिए:

कथन I: दो देशों के बीच मुक्त व्यापार समझौता को मोस्ट फेवर्ड नेशन सिद्धांत का उल्लंघन माना जाता है।

कथन II: मोस्ट फेवर्ड नेशन सिद्धांत के अनुसार कोई भी सदस्य देश व्यापार रियायतों के मामलों में सभी सदस्य देशों के साथ समान व्यवहार करेगा।

उपर्युक्त कथनों के संबंध में निम्नलिखित में से कौन-सा सही है?

a) कथन I और कथन II दोनों सही हैं तथा कथन II, कथन I की व्याख्या करता है

b) कथन I और कथन II दोनों सही हैं परन्तु कथन II, कथन I की व्याख्या नहीं करता

c) कथन I सही है परन्तु कथन II सही नहीं है

d) कथन I सही नहीं है परन्तु कथन II सही है

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.43) भारतीय अर्थव्यवस्था के संदर्भ में निम्नलिखित कथनों पर विचार कीजिए:

I. संप्रभु बाह्य ऋण (Sovereign External Debt) भारत के कुल बाह्य ऋण का लगभग 77 प्रतिशत है।

II. परिपक्वता की दृष्टि से दीर्घकालिक बाह्य ऋण कुल बाह्य ऋण का लगभग 80 प्रतिशत है।

III. बाह्य ऋण के मुद्रा-मूल्यांकन (denomination) के संदर्भ में भारतीय रुपया भारत के बाह्य ऋण का सबसे बड़ा घटक बना हुआ है।

उपर्युक्त में से कौन-से कथन सही हैं?

a) केवल II और III

b) केवल II

c) I, II और III

d) केवल I और III

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.44) वैश्विक अवसंरचना पहलों के संदर्भ में निम्नलिखित युग्मों पर विचार कीजिए:

अंतरराष्ट्रीय अवसंरचना पहल	**प्रारम्भ करने वाला**
I. ब्लू डॉट नेटवर्क	रूस
II. ग्लोबल गेटवे पहल	चीन
III. वैश्विक अवसंरचना और निवेश के लिए साझेदारी	भारत

उपर्युक्त में से कितने युग्म सही सुमेलित हैं?

a) केवल एक

b) केवल दो

c) सभी तीन

d) कोई नहीं

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.45) भारत सरकार ने हाल ही में एक नए राष्ट्रीय जीन बैंक की स्थापना की घोषणा की है। इस संदर्भ में निम्नलिखित कथनों में से कौन-सा सही है?

a) यह भारत में स्थापित होने वाला पहला जीन बैंक होगा।

b) यह जीन बैंक भविष्य की खाद्य और पोषण सुरक्षा के लिए लगभग 10 लाख फसल जर्मप्लाज्म का संरक्षण करेगा।

c) यह केंद्रीय बजट 2025-26 के "एक दिन एक जीनोम" विषय के अंतर्गत एक पहल होगी।

d) इसे राष्ट्रीय जैव विविधता प्राधिकरण द्वारा स्थापित और संचालित किया जाएगा।

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.46) With reference to Remission of Duties or Taxes on Exported Products (RoDTEP) scheme, consider the following statements:

I. It provides a mechanism for reimbursement of taxes, duties and levies, which are currently not being refunded under any other mechanism, at the central, state and local level, but which are incurred by the export entities in the process of manufacture and distribution of exported products.

II. Exporters of eligible items under the Scheme are being issued transferable electronic scrips as refund.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

a) I only
b) II only
c) Both I and II
d) Neither I nor II

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.47) Consider the following:

I. Anti-dumping duty
II. Local Content Requirement
III. Custom duty
IV. Import Quota

How many of the above can be considered as non-tariff barriers in International trade?

a) Only one
b) Only two
c) Only three
d) All the four

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.48) Consider the following statements regarding the New Development Bank (NDB):

I. Only the Sovereign Governments can borrow from the Bank.

II. Presently, all the members of BRICS are members of the New Development Bank.

III. Each member country of the bank will have equal voting rights.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

a) I only
b) I and II only
c) III only
d) None of the above

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.49) Convertibility of rupee implies

a) being able to convert rupee notes into gold
b) allowing the value of rupee to be fixed by market forces
c) freely permitting the conversion of rupee to other currencies and vice versa.
d) developing an international market for currencies in India.

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.50) With reference to the satellite launch facilities in India, consider the following statements:

Statement I: The Third Launch Pad (TLP) of the Indian Space Research Organisation (ISRO) will be established at Sriharikota.

Statement II: The rotational speed of Earth increases as one moves from the Equator towards the poles.

Which one of the following is correct in respect of the above statements?

a) Both Statement I and Statement II are correct and Statement II explains Statement I
b) Both Statement I and Statement II are correct but Statement II does not explain Statement I
c) Statement I is correct but Statement II is not correct
d) Statement I is not correct but Statement II is correct

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.51) Let x be a positive integer such that 7x+96 is divisible by x. How many values of x are possible?

a) 10
b) 11
c) 12
d) Infinitely many

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.46) निर्यातित उत्पादों पर शुल्कों एवं करों में छूट (RoDTEP) योजना के संदर्भ में निम्नलिखित कथनों पर विचार कीजिए:

I. यह निर्यातित उत्पादों के निर्माण और वितरण की प्रक्रिया में निर्यात इकाइयों द्वारा वहन किए जाने वाले उन करों, शुल्कों और उपकरों की प्रतिपूर्ति के लिए एक तंत्र प्रदान करती है, जो वर्तमान में किसी अन्य व्यवस्था के अंतर्गत वापस नहीं किए जा रहे हैं, और जो केंद्रीय, राज्य तथा स्थानीय स्तर पर लगाए जाते हैं।

II. योजना के अंतर्गत पात्र वस्तुओं के निर्यातकों को प्रतिपूर्ति के रूप में हस्तांतरणीय इलेक्ट्रॉनिक स्क्रिप जारी की जा रही हैं।

उपर्युक्त कथनों में से कौन-सा/से सही है/हैं?

a) केवल I
b) केवल II
c) I और II दोनों
d) न तो I और न ही II

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.47) निम्नलिखित पर विचार कीजिए:

I. एंटी-डम्पिंग शुल्क
II. स्थानीय सामग्री आवश्यकता
III. सीमा शुल्क
IV. आयात कोटा

उपर्युक्त में से कितनों को अंतर्राष्ट्रीय व्यापार में गैर-शुल्क बाधाओं के रूप में माना जा सकता है?

a) केवल एक
b) केवल दो
c) केवल तीन
d) सभी चार

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.48) न्यू डेवलपमेंट बैंक (NDB) के संबंध में निम्नलिखित कथनों पर विचार कीजिए:

I. केवल संप्रभु सरकारें ही बैंक से ऋण ले सकती हैं।
II. वर्तमान में, ब्रिक्स के सभी सदस्य न्यू डेवलपमेंट बैंक के सदस्य हैं।
III. बैंक के प्रत्येक सदस्य देश के पास समान मतदान अधिकार होंगे।

उपर्युक्त कथनों में से कौन-सा/से सही है/हैं?

a) केवल I
b) केवल I और II
c) केवल III
d) उपर्युक्त में से कोई नहीं

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.49) रुपये की परिवर्तनीयता का अर्थ है—

a) रुपये के नोटों को सोने में परिवर्तित करने में सक्षम होना
b) रुपये के मूल्य को बाजार शक्तियों द्वारा निर्धारित होने देना
c) रुपये को अन्य मुद्राओं में तथा अन्य मुद्राओं को रुपये में स्वतंत्र रूप से परिवर्तित करने की अनुमति देना
d) भारत में मुद्राओं के लिए एक अंतर्राष्ट्रीय बाजार का विकास करना

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.50) भारत में उपग्रह प्रक्षेपण सुविधाओं के संदर्भ में निम्नलिखित कथनों पर विचार कीजिए:

कथन I: भारतीय अंतरिक्ष अनुसंधान संगठन (ISRO) का तृतीय प्रक्षेपण परिसर (TLP) श्रीहरिकोटा में स्थापित किया जाएगा।

कथन II: पृथ्वी की घूर्णन गति भूमध्य रेखा से ध्रुवों की ओर बढ़ने पर बढ़ जाती है।

उपर्युक्त कथनों के संबंध में निम्नलिखित में से कौन-सा सही है?

a) कथन I और कथन II दोनों सही हैं तथा कथन II, कथन I की व्याख्या करता है
b) कथन I और कथन II दोनों सही हैं, लेकिन कथन II, कथन I की व्याख्या नहीं करता है
c) कथन I सही है, लेकिन कथन II सही नहीं है
d) कथन I सही नहीं है, लेकिन कथन II सही है

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.51) मान लीजिए (x) एक धनात्मक पूर्णांक है, ऐसा कि (7x + 96) संख्या (x) से विभाज्य है। (x) के कितने मान संभव हैं?

a) 10
b) 11
c) 12
d) अनंत

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.52) A natural number M is such that it can be expressed as M = a + b + c, where a, b, and c are three distinct proper factors of M, and none of them is 1. How many numbers below 60 have this property?
a) 6
b) 7
c) 8
d) 9

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.53) Let a and b be prime numbers such that $(a^3 + b^2)$ is also a prime number less than 100. What is the number of possible values of b?
a) 2
b) 3
c) 4
d) 5

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.54) What comes at P and Q respectively in the following sequence?
March, March, February, December, P, May, December, Q, November
a) September, July
b) September, June
c) August, July
d) August, June

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.55) What is the remainder when 65^{99} is divided by 11?
a) 0
b) 5
c) 9
d) 10

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.56) Two teams, A and B, played a certain number of matches against each other. Team A won exactly three-fourths of the matches played initially. Later, the teams played 7 additional matches, and team A lost all of these matches. After these additional games, it was observed that team A had won exactly two-thirds of the total matches played.
How many matches did Team A initially win?
a) 21
b) 35
c) 42
d) 63

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Directions for the following 4 (four) items:
Read the following three passages and answer the items that follow the passages. Your answers to these items should be based on the passages only

Passage - 1

Women often enter organisations carrying expectations shaped by years of socialisation, which can influence how they view leadership and their place within it. As a result, they may hesitate to articulate their ambitions or avoid taking visible risks. Women's leadership programmes can help address these challenges by creating spaces where participants can reflect on and challenge long-held beliefs and stereotypes about women in leadership positions. These programmes foster psychologically safe environments that enable deeper learning and genuine behavioural change. However, for such efforts to translate into meaningful progress, organisations must go beyond simply bringing women into the system and create environments where women are supported not only to enter the leadership pipeline but also to grow and remain within it.

Q.57) Which one of the following statements best reflects the most logical and rational inference that can be drawn from the passage?
a) Technical competence matters, but the right attitude is vital for becoming a leader.
b) Women often lack confidence in fully expressing themselves when stepping into leadership roles.
c) Without structural support, leadership programs alone cannot ensure women's advancement.
d) Leadership programs help counter socialization biases against women and create a foundation for their advancement.

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.52) एक प्राकृतिक संख्या M ऐसी है कि इसे M=a+b+c के रूप में व्यक्त किया जा सकता है, जहाँ a, b और c, M के तीन भिन्न वास्तविक गुणनखंड हैं, और इनमें से कोई भी 1 नहीं है। 60 से कम कितनी संख्याएँ इस गुणधर्म को संतुष्ट करती हैं?

a) 6
b) 7
c) 8
d) 9

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.53) मान लीजिए (a) और (b) अभाज्य संख्याएँ हैं, ऐसे कि ($a^3 + b^2$) भी 100 से कम एक अभाज्य संख्या है। b के संभावित मानों की संख्या क्या है?

a) 2
b) 3
c) 4
d) 5

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.54) निम्नलिखित अनुक्रम में क्रमशः P और Q के स्थान पर क्या आएगा?
मार्च, मार्च, फरवरी, दिसंबर, P, मई, दिसंबर, Q, नवंबर

a) सितंबर, जुलाई
b) सितंबर, जून
c) अगस्त, जुलाई
d) अगस्त, जून

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.55) जब 65^{99} को 11 से विभाजित किया जाता है, तो शेषफल क्या होगा?

a) 0
b) 5
c) 9
d) 10

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.56) दो टीमें, A और B, ने एक निश्चित संख्या में एक-दूसरे के विरुद्ध मैच खेले। टीम A ने प्रारम्भ में खेले गए मैचों में से ठीक तीन-चौथाई मैच जीते। बाद में, टीमों ने 7 अतिरिक्त मैच खेले और टीम A इन सभी मैचों में हार गई। इन अतिरिक्त मैचों के बाद यह देखा गया कि टीम A ने कुल खेले गए मैचों में से ठीक दो-तिहाई मैच जीते थे। टीम A ने प्रारम्भ में कितने मैच जीते थे?

a) 21
b) 35
c) 42
d) 63

100%		75%		50%		0%	

निम्नलिखित 4 (चार) प्रश्नों के लिए निर्देश:
निम्नलिखित तीन परिच्छेदों को पढ़िए और उनके बाद दिए गए प्रश्नों का उत्तर दीजिए। इन प्रश्नों के आपके उत्तर केवल परिच्छेदों के आधार पर होने चाहिए।

परिच्छेद - 1

महिलाएं अक्सर उन अपेक्षाओं को लेकर संगठनों में प्रवेश करती हैं जो वर्षों के समाजीकरण से निर्मित होती हैं, और ये अपेक्षाएँ इस बात को प्रभावित कर सकती हैं कि वे नेतृत्व को कैसे देखती हैं तथा उसमें अपने स्थान को कैसे समझती हैं। परिणामस्वरूप, वे अपनी महत्वाकांक्षाओं को व्यक्त करने में हिचक सकती हैं या स्पष्ट रूप से दिखाई देने वाले जोखिम लेने से बच सकती हैं। महिलाओं के नेतृत्व कार्यक्रम इन चुनौतियों का समाधान करने में सहायता कर सकते हैं, क्योंकि वे ऐसे स्थान उपलब्ध कराते हैं जहाँ प्रतिभागी नेतृत्व के पदों पर महिलाओं के संबंध में लंबे समय से प्रचलित धारणाओं और रूढ़ियों पर विचार कर सकें तथा उन्हें चुनौती दे सकें। ये कार्यक्रम मनोवैज्ञानिक रूप से सुरक्षित वातावरण को प्रोत्साहित करते हैं, जो गहन अधिगम और वास्तविक व्यवहार परिवर्तन को संभव बनाते हैं। तथापि, ऐसे प्रयासों को सार्थक प्रगति में परिवर्तित करने के लिए संगठनों को केवल महिलाओं को प्रणाली में शामिल करने से आगे बढ़ना होगा और ऐसे वातावरण का निर्माण करना होगा जहाँ महिलाओं को न केवल नेतृत्व की प्रक्रिया में प्रवेश करने के लिए, बल्कि उसमें विकसित होने और बने रहने के लिए भी समर्थन प्राप्त हो।

Q.57) निम्नलिखित में से कौन-सा कथन उस सबसे तार्किक और युक्तिसंगत निष्कर्ष को सर्वोत्तम रूप से प्रतिबिंबित करता है, जो इस परिच्छेद से निकाला जा सकता है?

a) तकनीकी दक्षता महत्त्वपूर्ण है, परंतु नेतृत्वकर्ता बनने के लिए सही दृष्टिकोण अत्यंत आवश्यक है।
b) नेतृत्व भूमिकाओं में प्रवेश करते समय महिलाएं प्रायः स्वयं को पूर्ण रूप से व्यक्त करने के प्रति आत्मविश्वास की कमी महसूस करती हैं।
c) संरचनात्मक समर्थन के बिना केवल नेतृत्व कार्यक्रम महिलाओं की उन्नति सुनिश्चित नहीं कर सकते।
d) नेतृत्व कार्यक्रम महिलाओं के विरुद्ध समाजीकरण से उत्पन्न पूर्वाग्रहों का प्रतिरोध करने में सहायता करते हैं और उनकी उन्नति के लिए आधार तैयार करते हैं।

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.58) With reference to the above passage, the following assumptions have been made:

I. Societal norms frequently undermine women's ability to assume leadership roles.

II. Leadership programs are necessary for unlocking the full potential of women.

Which of the above assumptions is/are valid?

a) I only

b) II only

c) Both I and II

d) Neither I nor II

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Passage - 2

To tackle the problem of pollution in cities, policy makers think that drastic actions like temporary use of odd-even number scheme for vehicles, closing schools, factories, construction activities, and banning the use of certain type of vehicles are a way forward. Even then the air is not clean. Vehicles more than 15 years old comprise one percent of the total; and taking them off the road will not make any difference. Banning certain fuels and car types arbitrarily is not proper. Diesel engines produce more PM 2.5 and less CO_2 than petrol or CNG engines. On the other hand, both diesel and CNG engines produce more NOx than petrol engines. No one has measured the amount of NOx that CNG engines are emitting. Arbitrary bans on vehicles that have passed mandated fitness tests and periodic pollution tests are unfair. What is needed is the scientific and reliable information about the source of pollutants on a continuing basis and the technologies that will work to reduce pollution form them.

Q.59) Which one of the following statements best reflects the most logical and rational implication conveyed by the passage?

a) Arbitrary curbs on vehicles to reduce pollution are difficult to implement.

b) Knee-jerk reactions cannot solve the problem of pollution but an evidence based approach will be more effective.

c) A heavy penalty should be enforced on those driving without periodic pollution tests.

d) In the absence of laws to deal with the problems of pollution, the administration tends to make arbitrary decisions.

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Passage - 3

There was a time when being stuck meant slowing down. Answers had to be searched for in books, libraries, interviews, and research. The process could be frustrating, but it demanded engagement. One had to explore sources, connect ideas, challenge assumptions, and arrive at conclusions independently. Critical thinking was not an optional skill that could be outsourced. Today, however, AI can generate an instant answer, and tasks that once took hours now takes minutes. Quantitative productivity has undeniably improved, but speed comes with trade-offs. When answers are readily available, the need to wrestle with questions begins to fade, even though it is often in that very struggle that critical thinking is sharpened. The key, then, is to use AI thoughtfully, as a guide and a partner rather than a replacement, so that the mind remains engaged and the process of thinking itself is never lost.

Q.60) Which one of the following statements best reflects the crux of the passage?

a) Engaging in research through reading books cultivates critical thinking and enhances one's analytical skills.

b) Humans have outsourced their thinking to artificial intelligence, weakening their capacity for critical thought.

c) Artificial intelligence should serve as a tool for thinking and learning, not a replacement for them.

d) AI makes learning more efficient by enhancing productivity and delivering information instantly.

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.58) उपर्युक्त परिच्छेद के संदर्भ में निम्नलिखित धारणाएँ बनाई गई हैं:

I. सामाजिक मानदंड अक्सर महिलाओं की नेतृत्व की भूमिका ग्रहण करने की क्षमता को कमजोर कर देते हैं।

II. महिलाओं की पूर्ण क्षमता को उजागर करने के लिए नेतृत्व कार्यक्रम आवश्यक हैं।

उपर्युक्त में से कौन-सी धारणा/धारणाएँ सही हैं?

a) केवल I

b) केवल II

c) I और II दोनों

d) न तो I और न ही II

100%		75%		50%		0%	

परिच्छेद - 2

शहरों में प्रदूषण की समस्या से निपटने के लिए नीति-निर्माता यह सोचते हैं कि वाहनों के लिए अस्थायी रूप से ऑड-ईवन नंबर स्कीम लागू करना, स्कूलों, कारखानों और निर्माण गतिविधियों को बंद करना तथा कुछ प्रकार के वाहनों के उपयोग पर प्रतिबंध लगाना आगे बढ़ने का एक तरीका है। इसके बावजूद भी वायु स्वच्छ नहीं होती। 15 वर्ष से अधिक पुराने वाहन कुल वाहनों का केवल एक प्रतिशत हैं; और उन्हें सड़कों से हटाने से कोई विशेष अंतर नहीं पड़ेगा। कुछ ईंधनों और कारों के प्रकारों पर मनमाने ढंग से प्रतिबंध लगाना उचित नहीं है। डीज़ल इंजन पेट्रोल या CNG इंजनों की तुलना में अधिक PM 2.5 और कम CO_2 उत्पन्न करते हैं। दूसरी ओर, डीज़ल और CNG दोनों इंजन पेट्रोल इंजनों की तुलना में अधिक NOx उत्पन्न करते हैं। किसी ने यह मापा ही नहीं है कि CNG इंजन कितनी मात्रा में NOx उत्सर्जित कर रहे हैं। जिन वाहनों ने अनिवार्य फिटनेस परीक्षण और आवधिक प्रदूषण परीक्षण पास कर लिए हैं, उन पर मनमाने प्रतिबंध लगाना अनुचित है। आवश्यकता इस बात की है कि प्रदूषकों के स्रोतों के बारे में निरंतर आधार पर वैज्ञानिक और विश्वसनीय जानकारी उपलब्ध हो तथा उन तकनीकों की पहचान की जाए जो उनसे होने वाले प्रदूषण को कम करने में प्रभावी हों।

Q.59) निम्नलिखित में से कौन-सा कथन परिच्छेद द्वारा व्यक्त सबसे तार्किक और युक्तिसंगत निहितार्थ को सर्वोत्तम रूप से प्रतिबिंबित करता है?

a) प्रदूषण को कम करने के लिए वाहनों पर मनमाने प्रतिबंध लागू करना कठिन है।

b) त्वरित और बिना सोचे-समझे किए गए उपाय प्रदूषण की समस्या का समाधान नहीं कर सकते, बल्कि प्रमाण-आधारित दृष्टिकोण अधिक प्रभावी होगा।

c) जो लोग आवधिक प्रदूषण परीक्षण के बिना वाहन चलाते हैं, उन पर कठोर दंड लगाया जाना चाहिए।

d) प्रदूषण की समस्या से निपटने के लिए कानूनों के अभाव में प्रशासन प्रायः मनमाने निर्णय लेने लगता है।

100%		75%		50%		0%	

परिच्छेद - 3

एक समय था जब किसी समस्या में अटक जाने का अर्थ होता था गति धीमी हो जाना। उत्तरों की खोज पुस्तकों, पुस्तकालयों, साक्षात्कारों और शोध में करनी पड़ती थी। यह प्रक्रिया कभी-कभी निराशाजनक हो सकती थी, परंतु इसके लिए सक्रिय सहभागिता आवश्यक होती थी। व्यक्ति को विभिन्न स्रोतों का अन्वेषण करना पड़ता था, विचारों को जोड़ना पड़ता था, मान्यताओं को चुनौती देनी पड़ती थी और स्वतंत्र रूप से निष्कर्षों तक पहुँचना पड़ता था। आलोचनात्मक चिंतन ऐसा कौशल नहीं था जिसे किसी अन्य पर छोड़ा जा सके। आज, हालांकि, AI तुरंत उत्तर उत्पन्न कर सकता है, और जिन कार्यों में पहले घंटों लगते थे वे अब मिनटों में पूरे हो जाते हैं। मात्रात्मक उत्पादकता निस्संदेह बढ़ी है, परंतु गति के साथ कुछ समझौते भी जुड़े होते हैं। जब उत्तर सहज रूप से उपलब्ध हो जाते हैं, तो प्रश्नों से जूझने की आवश्यकता कम होने लगती है, जबकि प्रायः इसी संघर्ष की प्रक्रिया में आलोचनात्मक चिंतन अधिक तीक्ष्ण होता है। अतः मुख्य बात यह है कि AI का उपयोग विचारपूर्वक किया जाए—एक मार्गदर्शक और सहयोगी के रूप में, न कि उसके स्थानापन्न के रूप में—ताकि मस्तिष्क सक्रिय बना रहे और विचार करने की प्रक्रिया स्वयं कभी न खो जाए।

Q.60) निम्नलिखित में से कौन-सा कथन परिच्छेद के मूल सार को सर्वोत्तम रूप से प्रतिबिंबित करता है?

a) पुस्तकों को पढ़कर शोध करने की प्रक्रिया आलोचनात्मक चिंतन को विकसित करती है और विश्लेषणात्मक कौशल को बढ़ाती है।

b) मनुष्यों ने अपने विचार करने की क्षमता को कृत्रिम बुद्धिमत्ता को सौंप दिया है, जिससे उनकी आलोचनात्मक सोच की क्षमता कमजोर हो गई है।

c) कृत्रिम बुद्धिमत्ता को सोचने और सीखने के लिए एक उपकरण के रूप में कार्य करना चाहिए, न कि उनके स्थानापन्न के रूप में।

d) AI उत्पादकता बढ़ाकर और तुरंत जानकारी प्रदान करके सीखने को अधिक प्रभावी बनाता है।

100%		75%		50%		0%	

SPACE FOR ROUGH WORK

Q.1) Consider the following statements in respect of the International Bank for Reconstruction and Development (IBRD):
I. It provides loans and guarantees to middle income countries.
II. It works single-handedly to help developing countries to reduce poverty.
III. It was established to help Europe rebuild after the World War II.
Which of the statements given above are correct?
a) I and II only
b) II and III only
c) I and III only
d) I, II and III

Ans) c
Exp) Option c is the correct answer.
The International Bank for Reconstruction and Development (IBRD) is a global development cooperative owned by 189 member countries and is also the largest development bank in the world.
Statement I is correct: The IBRD primarily lends to middle-income countries and some creditworthy low-income countries. It offers financial products such as loans, guarantees, risk management products, and advisory services to support development programs, infrastructure projects, and economic reforms. The goal is to reduce poverty and promote sustainable development in these countries.
Statement II is incorrect: The IBRD is not the only institution working on poverty reduction. It is one of five institutions that make up the World Bank Group, which includes:

- IDA (International Development Association) – for the poorest countries
- IFC (International Finance Corporation) – for private sector development
- MIGA (Multilateral Investment Guarantee Agency) – for political risk insurance
- ICSID (International Centre for Settlement of Investment Disputes) – for arbitration

Together, these institutions work collaboratively, not "single-handedly," to reduce poverty and promote development.
Statement III is correct: The IBRD was indeed established in 1944 at the Bretton Woods Conference with the primary goal of financing the reconstruction of European nations devastated by World War II. After the post-war reconstruction, its mandate expanded to global economic development and poverty eradication.
Source: UPSC CSE Pre 2025
Subject:) Economy
Topic:) Global finance Architecture
Subtopic:)

Q.2) Consider the following goods:
I. Electronic Goods
II. Petroleum Products
III. Gems and Jewellery
With reference to the goods mentioned above, which of the following is the correct descending order with respect to their export value from India during FY 2024–25?
a) I - II - III
b) III - I - II
c) II - I - III
d) III - II - I

Ans) c
Exp) Option c is the correct answer.
The correct chronological order is- Petroleum Products - Electronic Goods - Gems and Jewellery.
Option II. Petroleum products are among India's **largest export items**. India imports crude oil, refines it in its large refinery network, and exports refined petroleum products to many countries. In **FY 2024–25**, petroleum products recorded exports of about **USD 60.07 billion.**

Option I. Electronic goods have become an important export sector due to the growth of **electronics manufacturing and assembly in India**, supported by initiatives such as production-linked incentives (PLI). In FY 2024–25, exports of electronic goods were about **USD 38.56 billion.**

Option III. India is a major global hub for **cutting and polishing diamonds and manufacturing jewellery**. The sector contributes significantly to exports,in FY 2024–25, exports of gems and jewellery were about **USD 29.80 billion**.

Source:) https://niryat.gov.in/#?start_date=202404&end_date=202503&sort_table=export_achieved-sort-desc

Subject:) Economy

Topic:) External Sector

Subtopic:)

Q.3) With reference to the Balance of Payments (BoP), which of the following factors can negatively affect the Current Account of a country?

I. A higher rate of inflation in the domestic country

II. A rise in national income of the country

III. Imposition of import tariffs by domestic government

IV. Depreciation of the domestic currency

Select the correct answer using the code given below:

a) I, II and III

b) I and II only

c) II, III and IV

d) I, III and IV

Ans) b

Exp) Option b is the correct answer.

The **Current Account** is a key component of a country's **Balance of Payments (BoP)**. It records transactions related to **trade in goods, services, income, and transfers** between residents of a country and the rest of the world.

Option I is correct. When domestic inflation is higher than that of trading partners, **domestic goods become relatively expensive** in international markets. As a result, **exports decline while imports increase**, leading to a **current account deficit**. Thus, **negatively affects the current account**.

Option II is correct. When people's **income increases**, they tend to **consume more goods and services**, including **foreign products**. This raises **imports**, which may worsen the current account balance. Thus, **negatively affects the current account**.

Option III is incorrect. Tariffs are **taxes on imports**. When the government imposes tariffs or other import restrictions, imported goods become **more expensive**, reducing their demand. This can **reduce imports and improve the current account**, so it does **not negatively affect** the current account.

Option IV is incorrect. Currency depreciation makes **exports cheaper and more competitive in global markets**, while imports become **more expensive**. This tends to **increase exports and reduce imports**, thereby **improving the current account** rather than worsening it, so it does **not negatively affect** the current account.

Source:) https://egyankosh.ac.in/bitstream/123456789/79474/1/Unit-11.pdf (Page 7)

Subject:) Economy

Topic:) Balance Of Payment

Subtopic:)

Q.4) Which of the following best describes the primary objective of the Advance Authorisation Scheme (AAS) implemented under India's Foreign Trade Policy?

a) To provide financial subsidies to Micro, Small and Medium Enterprises (MSMEs) for establishing export-oriented production units.

b) To allow the duty-free import of inputs that are physically incorporated in products meant for export.

c) To allow exporters to obtain long-term credit from banks at concessional interest rates.

d) To provide tax rebates on profits earned by firms engaged in international trade.

Ans) b

Exp) Option b is the correct answer.

The **Advance Authorisation Scheme (AAS)** is an export promotion scheme under India's **Foreign Trade Policy (FTP)**. The Scheme **allows duty free import of inputs, which are physically incorporated in an export product.** In addition to any inputs, packaging material, fuel, oil, and catalyst which is consumed / utilized in the process of production of export products, is also allowed.

The scheme is administered by the **Directorate General of Foreign Trade (DGFT)** and is designed to make Indian exports more competitive in global markets.

Source:) https://www.dgft.gov.in/CP/?opt=adnavce-authorisation
https://cag.gov.in/uploads/download_audit_report/2021/04-CUSTOM%20ENGLISH%202021%20REPORT%20NO-10%20%20Chapter-I-061c1b619d88393.78740693.pdf

Subject:) Economy

Topic:) External Sector

Subtopic:)

Q.5) What is the primary purpose of 'CROPS,' a project of the Indian Space Research Organisation (ISRO)?

a) To provide soil testing facilities to farmers in remote areas.

b) To provide satellite-enabled services, like weather forecasting, to Indian farmers.

c) To develop capabilities for growing and sustaining plants in space.

d) To enhance agricultural productivity and promote crop diversification in India.

Ans) c

Exp) Option c is the correct answer.

CROPS stands for Compact Research Module for Orbital Plant Studies. It is **an unmanned experimental module designed to develop ISRO's capabilities for growing and sustaining plants in space**. CROPS first mission (CROPS – 1) is designed to demonstrate germination of a seed and growth of plant up to two leaves stage in space. It is an airtight container of diameter 300mm and height 450mm simulating an earth like environment in space except gravity.

ISRO has achieved a remarkable feat by successfully germinating cowpea seeds in microgravity conditions during its PSLV-C60 POEM-4 mission.

CROPS is an automated system designed to study seed germination and plant survival in microgravity.

Microgravity refers to conditions where gravity is minimal or where objects experience free fall, such as inside the International Space Station (ISS).

Source: SFG ESSENTIAL, CURRENT AFFAIRS, QUARTERLY COMPILATION (JANUARY– MARCH 2025)

Subject:) Current Affairs

Topic:) Science & Technology

Subtopic:)

Q.6) With reference to the Balance of Payments (BoP) of a country, consider the following transactions:

I. A United States of America citizen purchases bonds issued by the Government of India.

II. An Indian company receives Foreign Direct Investment (FDI) from a Japanese firm to establish a manufacturing unit in India.

III. An Indian resident receives remittances from a family member working in the United Kingdom.

IV. The Government of India repays the principal amount of external loan taken from an international financial institution.

V. An Indian software company receives payment for providing IT services to a client in Germany.

How many of the above transactions are recorded under the Capital Account of India's Balance of Payments?

a) Only two

b) Only three

c) Only four

d) All the five

Ans) b

Exp) Option b is the correct answer.

The **Balance of Payments (BoP)** is a record of all economic transactions between the residents of a country and the rest of the world during a specific period. It is mainly divided into two major components, the **Current Account** and the **Capital Account**. The **Capital Account records all transactions in assets**.

Statement I is correct. When a **United States of America citizen purchases Indian government bonds**, they are essentially lending money to India. This leads to an increase in India's external liabilities and is therefore recorded as a **capital account** inflow in the Balance of Payments.

Statement II is correct. FDI from the Japanese firm is a long-term investment into India's productive capacity, representing an increase in foreign-owned assets within India, thus placing it in the **Capital Account.**

Statement III is incorrect. Remittances from a family member in the UK are treated as unilateral transfers that don't create an asset or a debt, so they fall under the **Current Account.**

Statement IV is correct. Repayment of an external loan by the Government of India reduces India's external liabilities and is **recorded under the Capital Account** of the Balance of Payments.

Statement V is incorrect. The **payment for IT services** from Germany is an export of a service. It is income earned from work performed, similar to selling a product, which is a **Current Account** entry.

Source:) NCERT- Macroeconomy, Chapter 6- Open Economy Macroeconomics- Page 86-88

Subject:) Economy

Topic:) Balance Of Payment

Subtopic:)

Q.7) In the context of maritime trade, the term Demurrage which was seen recently in news refers to:

a) The additional insurance premium paid by freight carriers while navigating through high-risk conflict zones.

b) The preferential treatment regarding port access fees given to specific countries under a regional maritime cooperation treaty.

c) The transit fee imposed by a country for allowing cargo to pass through its territory.

d) The charge paid by the merchant when cargo containers remain at the terminal beyond the permitted free time.

Ans) d

Exp) Option d is the correct answer.

To ensure the swift movement or return of containers, shipping lines provide a specified free time period for the use of containers at the port or terminal. If merchants exceed this free time, shipping lines impose demurrage and detention charges.

Demurrage specifically refers to the charge paid by the merchant for keeping the container inside the port or terminal beyond the permitted free time period. In recent years, the free time allowed has been reduced, while demurrage and detention tariffs have increased globally to encourage faster cargo clearance and container turnaround.

Source:) https://unctad.org/news/demurrage-and-detention-charges-container-shipping
https://indianexpress.com/article/explained/explained-economics/west-asia-conflict-india-rice-exports-10565738/

Subject:) Economy

Topic:) External Sector

Subtopic:)

Q.8) With reference to WTO Agreement on Trade-Related Aspects of Intellectual Property Rights (TRIPS), consider the following statements:

I. It was an outcome of the Uruguay Round of the General Agreement on Tariffs and Trade (GATT) negotiations.

II. Copyrights and related rights is one of the Intellectual Property Rights covered under the TRIPS agreement.

III. The World Intellectual Property Organization (WIPO) was established under the TRIPS Agreement.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

a) I only

b) II and III only
c) I and II only
d) I, II and III

Ans) c
Exp) Option c is the correct answer.
The Trade-Related Aspects of Intellectual Property Rights (TRIPS) Agreement is a comprehensive multilateral agreement on intellectual property (IP) rights, administered by the World Trade Organization (WTO). It establishes minimum standards for various forms of IP regulation applicable to WTO member nations.
Statement I is correct: The TRIPS Agreement was an outcome of the Uruguay Round of the General Agreement on Tariffs and Trade (GATT) negotiations, which took place from 1986 to 1994. These negotiations led to the establishment of the WTO, with TRIPS being one of its key agreements.
Statement II is correct: The TRIPS Agreement is, by its coverage, the most comprehensive international instrument on Intellectual Property Rights (IPRs), dealing with almost all types of IPRs (**copyright and related rights**, trademarks, geographical indications, industrial designs, patents, layout-designs of integrated circuits, and protection of undisclosed information/trade secrets), with the sole exception of breeders' rights. Under the International Union for the Protection of New Varieties of Plants (UPOV) , breeders of new plant varieties are granted an intellectual property right known as the breeder's right, which incentivizes innovation in plant breeding.
Statement III is incorrect: The World Intellectual Property Organization (WIPO) is the United Nations agency established in 1967 (not established under TRIPS Agreement) which serves the world's innovators and creators, ensuring that their ideas travel safely to the market and improve lives everywhere.
Source:) https://www.wto.org/english/tratop_e/trips_e/tripfq_e.htm
https://www.commerce.gov.in/international-trade/india-and-world-trade-organization-wto/the-agreement-on-trade-related-aspects-of-intellectual-property-rights-trips/#:~:text=The%20TRIPS%20Agreement%20is%2C%20by,sole%20exception%20of%20breeders'%20rights.
https://www.wipo.int/en/web/about-wipo
Subject:) Economy
Topic:) Global finance Architecture
Subtopic:)

Q.9) With reference to SWIFT (The Society for Worldwide Interbank Financial Telecommunication) system, consider the following statements:
I. It is an international network developed in collaboration between the Bank for International Settlements and the International Monetary Fund (IMF).
II. All the IMF member countries are members of the SWIFT system.
III. It is a secure messaging system that helps financial institutions send payment instructions.
Which of the statements given above is/are correct?
a) I and II only
b) III only
c) I and III only
d) None of the above

Ans) b
Exp) Option b is the correct answer.
Statement I is incorrect: SWIFT (Society for Worldwide Interbank Financial Telecommunication) network is **founded in 1973 by a group of 239 banks from 15 countries (not by Bank for International Settlements and International Monetary Fund)** which formed a co-operative utility to develop a secure electronic messaging service and common standards to facilitate cross-border payments.
Statement II is incorrect: The SWIFT is a global member-owned cooperative that is **headquartered in Brussels, Belgium. Sovereign governments are not its members.**

The International Monetary Fund (IMF) is an organization of 191 countries, working to foster global monetary cooperation, secure financial stability, facilitate international trade, promote high employment and sustainable economic growth, and reduce poverty around the world.

Statement III is correct: SWIFT is a secure messaging system that helps financial institutions send payment instructions. It facilitates the transfer of value across the globe, but does not actually move money. The actual transfer of funds happens through banks, fintechs, and other institutions.

Source:) https://www.thehindu.com/business/the-lowdown-on-swift-and-bank-fraud/article22846010.ece
https://www.business-standard.com/industry/banking/swift-global-banks-to-roll-out-new-framework-for-faster-cross-border-payments-126030501116_1.html
https://www.thehindu.com/news/international/explained-what-is-swift-and-why-is-russia-being-threatened-with-exclusion-from-the-service/article38400867.ece
Subject:) Economy
Topic:) Global finance Architecture
Subtopic:)

Q.10) Which of the following statements correctly describes the Global Plastic Action Partnership (GPAP)?
a) It is an initiative of the World Economic Forum, that aimed at combating plastic pollution worldwide.
b) It is a flagship initiative of the United Nations Environment Programme, that aims to reduce plastic pollution.
c) It is a partnership between the World Wide Fund for Nature and the International Union for Conservation of Nature that works to combat marine plastic pollution.
d) It is a global commitment led by the Ellen MacArthur Foundation, that unites businesses, governments, NGOs, and investors.

Ans) a
Exp) Option a is the correct answer.
The Global Plastic Action Partnership (GPAP) is an initiative launched by the World Economic Forum. It **is aimed at combating plastic pollution worldwide.** GPAP focuses on creating a circular plastics economy, where plastic is reused, recycled, and managed more sustainably.
GPAP's goal is to stop plastic waste leakage and foster a shift toward sustainable materials.
The Global Plastic Action Partnership (GPAP) has achieved its goal of establishing 25 national partnerships by 2025, making it the world's largest initiative tackling plastic pollution. It has recently reached a significant milestone by expanding its network to include 25 countries.
Recently, seven new countries – Angola, Bangladesh, Gabon, Guatemala, Kenya, Senegal, and Tanzania – have joined this.
Maharashtra state joined GPAP in May 2022 to advance regional efforts to fight plastic pollution.
Source: SFG ESSENTIAL, CURRENT AFFAIRS, QUARTERLY COMPILATION (JANUARY– MARCH 2025)
Subject:) Current Affairs
Topic:) Environment
Subtopic:)

Q.11) Which one of the following would be considered as Foreign Direct Investment?
a) A foreign company buying shares in stock exchanges in India
b) A foreign country pension fund investing in Indian stock markets
c) A foreign merchant banker buying shares from Indian stock markets
d) A foreign entity setting up an educational institution in India

Ans) d
Exp) Option d is the correct answer.
Foreign Direct Investment (FDI) refers to the **investment made by a foreign entity or individual in a business or venture located in another country.** It involves a long-term investment that provides the foreign investor with a significant degree of control or ownership over the invested entity.

Option d is correct: A foreign entity setting up an **educational institution in India is considered Foreign Direct Investment (FDI).** It involves a long-term investment by a foreign entity to establish and operate an educational institution in India, which provides the foreign investor with direct control and ownership over the institution.

Option a is incorrect: A foreign company buying shares in stock exchanges in India is not considered Foreign Direct Investment. It is categorized as Foreign Institutional Investment (FII) or Foreign Portfolio Investment (FPI), where the foreign investor purchases shares in publicly traded companies without having direct control or ownership over the invested entity.

Option b is incorrect: A foreign country pension fund investing in Indian stock markets is also categorized as Foreign Institutional Investment (FII) or Foreign Portfolio Investment (FPI) because it involves the purchase of shares in stock markets without direct control or ownership over the invested entity.

Option c is incorrect: A foreign merchant banker buying shares from Indian stock markets falls under Foreign Institutional Investment (FII) or Foreign Portfolio Investment (FPI), as it involves buying shares without direct control or ownership.

Source: UPSC CDS [I] 2022
Subject:) Economy
Topic:) Balance Of Payment
Subtopic:)

Q.12) With reference to the Foreign Direct Investment (FDI) into India, consider the following states:
I. Maharashtra
II. Gujarat
III. Karnataka
IV. Tamil Nadu
Which one of the following correctly represents the descending order of overall FDI equity inflows in the state given above in FY 2024-25?
a) I – II – III – IV
b) I – III – II – IV
c) II – I – III – IV
d) I – II – IV – III

Ans) b
Exp) Option b is the correct answer
The Government of India has put in place an investor-friendly Foreign Direct Investment (FDI) policy, under which most sectors are open for 100% FDI through the automatic route. FDI inflows have seen a steady rise—from USD 36.05 billion in FY 2013–14 to USD 81.04 billion in FY 2024–25, marking a 14% increase from USD 71.28 billion in FY 2023–24. **The services sector emerged as the top recipient of FDI equity in FY 2024–25**, attracting 19% of total inflows, followed by computer software and hardware (16%) and trading (8%).
Maharashtra leads the way in terms of overall FDI equity inflows in FY 2024-25, accounting for 39%, followed by Karnataka (13%) and Delhi (12%).
Maharashtra (I) accounts for 39% i.e. Rs. 164,875 Crores FDI equity inflows in FY 2024-25
Karnataka (III) accounts for 13% i.e. Rs. 56,030 Crores FDI equity inflows in FY 2024-25
Gujarat (II) accounts for Rs. 47,947 Crores FDI equity inflows in FY 2024-25
Tamil Nadu (IV) accounts for Rs. 31,103 Crores FDI equity inflows in FY 2024-25
Source: https://indianexpress.com/article/trending/top-10-listing/top-10-indian-states-by-foreign-direct-investment-fdi-inflows-in-2025-10197783/
https://www.dpiit.gov.in/static/uploads/2025/07/03ad41d0e0c3deb434e0520f5dda6df3.pdf (page 3)
Subject:) Economy
Topic:) Balance Of Payment
Subtopic:)

Q.13) In the context of the Indian Economy, which of the following institutions function under the Ministry of Commerce?
I. Export Credit Guarantee Corporation of India
II. Agricultural and Processed Food Products Export Development Authority (APEDA)
III. Marine Products Export Development Authority
Select the correct answer using the code given below:
a) I and II only
b) I and III only
c) II and III only
d) I, II and III

Ans) d
Exp) Option d is the correct answer.
Option I is correct: Export Credit Guarantee Corporation of India Limited is wholly owned by the government of India functioning under the Ministry of Commerce. It was set up in 1957 with the objective of promoting exports from the country by providing credit risk insurance and related services for exports.
Option II is correct: The **Agricultural and Processed Food Products Export Development Authority (APEDA)** is a **statutory body** established by the Government of India under the APEDA Act passed by Parliament in December 1985. APEDA **functions under the Ministry of Commerce and Industry** and was created to promote the export of agricultural and processed food products, replacing the earlier Processed Food Export Promotion Council (PFEPC).
Option III is correct: The Marine Products Export Development Authority (MPEDA) was established by an Act of Parliament in 1972 and functions under the Ministry of Commerce and Industry. The earlier Marine Products Export Promotion Council, set up by the Government of India in September 1961, was merged into MPEDA on 24 August 1972. MPEDA serves as the nodal agency for the holistic development of the seafood industry in India and works to realize its full export potential.
Source:) https://www.commerce.gov.in/about-us/public-sector-undertakings/export-credit-guarantee-corporation-of-india-limited/
https://apeda.gov.in/about-us
https://www.pib.gov.in/PressReleasePage.aspx?PRID=1658142&reg=3&lang=2
https://indiantradeportal.in/vs.jsp?lang=0&id=0,31,223,24369#epc
https://mpeda.gov.in/?page_id=386
Subject:) Economy
Topic:) External Sector
Subtopic:)

Q.14) Consider the following statements:
The net exports are also termed as the trade balance, is the net sum of a country's exports and imports in:
I. goods
II. services
Which of the statements given above is/are correct?
a) I only
b) II only
c) Both I and II
d) neither I nor II

Ans) c
Exp) Option c is the correct answer
Statements I and II are correct: The **net exports are also termed as the trade balance, which is the net sum of a country's exports and imports in goods as well as in services.** Trade in services is often said to be invisible as they cannot be seen to cross national borders.
The trade balance reflects a surplus (positive) if the value of exports of a country exceeds its imports while it is said to reflect a deficit (negative) if the value of imports of a country is higher than its exports.

Source: https://egyankosh.ac.in/bitstream/123456789/79474/1/Unit-11.pdf (Page 3)
https://ncert.nic.in/textbook/pdf/legy108.pdf (page 73)
Subject:) Economy
Topic:) Balance Of Payment
Subtopic:)

Q.15) Operation Sindhu, which was in the news recently, refers to:
a) A mission to evacuate Indian nationals from conflict zones in Iran.
b) A naval exercise between India and Southeast Asian nations in the South China Sea.
c) A disaster relief operation in response to a major earthquake in Central Asia.
d) An initiative to promote sustainable fishing practices in the Indian Ocean.

Ans) a
Exp) Option a is the correct answer
In view of the developments in West Asia (in June 2025), the Government of India launched Operation Sindhu to evacuate Indian nationals from conflict zones in Iran and Israel.
Source: ForumIAS Current Affairs Class notes
Subject:) Current Affairs
Topic:) International Relations
Subtopic:)

Q.16) In the context of Indian Economy, the Net International Investment Position (NIIP) will be negative when:
a) India's total foreign liabilities exceed its total foreign assets.
b) India's total Foreign Direct Investment outflows exceed the Foreign Direct Investment inflows it receives.
c) India's net current account balance exceeds the capital account balance.
d) India's net inflow of Foreign Portfolio investment exceeds the net inflow of Foreign Direct Investment.

Ans) a
Exp) Option a is the correct answer.
The International Investment Position (IIP) shows the stock of international financial assets and liabilities at a point in time.
On the assets side, the IIP includes all foreign financial assets that Indians own, including the international reserves held by the central bank. On the liabilities side, it consists of domestic assets that foreigners own, such as direct and portfolio investment into India and external debt in the form of bonds, loans, deposits and trade credit.
The difference between these assets and liabilities is called the Net International Investment Position (NIIP). When a country's foreign liabilities exceed its foreign assets, the NIIP becomes negative, indicating that the country is net in debt to the rest of the world.
In India's case, foreign liabilities exceed foreign assets, and therefore India's NIIP is negative. Between 2003 and 2023, this net liability increased from $60 billion to $396 billion, rising from 9.9% to 11.1% of GDP. Compared with other G20 countries, the United States is the most indebted, Japan is the largest creditor, while India lies somewhere in between.
Source:) https://www.livemint.com/economy/india-can-cheer-its-low-debt-but-here-s-the-catch-11717302575268.html
Subject:) Economy
Topic:) External Sector
Subtopic:)

Q.17) Consider the following statements:
An increase in Nominal Effective Exchange Rate of the country indicates:
I. the appreciation of domestic currency against its major trading partners.
II. an improvement in trade competitiveness of the country.
Which of the statements given above is/are correct?
a) I only

b) II only
c) Both I and II
d) Neither I nor II

Ans) a
Exp) Option a is the correct answer.
The Nominal Effective Exchange Rate measures the average value of a country's currency compared to a basket of other currencies each weighted by its importance to the domestic country in international trade.
Statement I is correct.
Consider a hypothetical situation:
Imagine Country X trades mainly with three countries: Country A, Country B and Country C.

Country X currency	Basket currencies (equal weightage)
1 Unit	100 Unit of A
1 Unit	200 Unit of B
1 Unit	300 Unit of C
NEER	200 (average of all three)

Now if NEER of country X was 200 in 2024 and it has risen by 8% next year to 216 that means the currency of country X has appreciated on an average against other trading countries.
Statement II is incorrect.
An increasing Nominal Effective Exchange Rate (NEER) indicates an appreciation of a country's currency against its trading partners. This **generally reduces trade competitiveness**, as it makes exports more expensive and imports cheaper for foreign buyers. A lower NEER (depreciation) usually improves competitiveness.
Source:) Class 12th old NCERT: Macroeconomics,chapter-6, para 6.2, P 78-79
Subject:) Economy
Topic:) External Sector
Subtopic:)

Q.18) Consider the following statements:
I. Purchasing Power Parity exchange rate is the rate at which the currency of one country would have to be converted into that of another country to buy the same amount of goods and services in each country
II. India is the third-largest economy in the world in terms of GDP based on purchasing power parity (PPP).
Which of the statements given above is/are correct?
a) I only
b) II only
c) Both I and II
d) Neither I nor II

Ans) c
Exp) Option c is the correct answer.
The **nominal exchange rate** is the rate at which one country's currency can be exchanged for another country's currency. It simply shows the monetary value of one currency in terms of another. The nominal exchange rate only tells us the currency value, not how expensive or cheap goods are in different countries.
The **real exchange rate** measures the price of foreign goods relative to domestic goods, after adjusting for price levels in both countries. It helps in understanding how costly goods are across countries.

$$\text{Real Exchange Rate} = \frac{e \times P_f}{P}$$

Where:
- e = Nominal exchange rate (domestic currency per unit of foreign currency)
- P^f = Price level in the foreign country
- P = Price level in the domestic country

Statement I is correct. Purchasing Power Parity (PPP) occurs when the real exchange rate is equal to 1. This means that the same goods cost the same in both countries when measured in the same currency.
In simple terms Purchasing Power Parity means one unit of currency should buy the same quantity of goods in different countries.
Thus, **Purchasing Power Parity exchange rate is the rate at which the currency of one country would have to be converted into that of another country to buy the same amount of goods and services in each country**
Statement II is correct. India is the third-largest economy in the world in terms of GDP based on purchasing power parity (PPP) with a GDP size of 16.02 trillion USD, as per the IMF's recent data, trailing behind China and the US.
Source:) Class 12th old NCERT: Macroeconomics, chapter-6, P 79
https://indianexpress.com/article/trending/top-10-listing/year-ender-2024-how-did-india-rank-on-global-economic-indexes-this-year-9746657/
Subject:) Economy
Topic:) External Sector
Subtopic:)

Q.19) Consider the following statements with reference to the International Finance Corporation:
I. Globally, India has the highest investment portfolio exposure of the International Finance Corporation (IFC).
II. Being the private arm of the World Bank, it can lend directly to micro, small, and medium enterprises or individual entrepreneurs.
Which of the statements given above is/are correct?
a) I only
b) II only
c) Both I and II
d) Neither I nor II

Ans) a
Exp) Option a is the correct answer.
The International Finance Corporation (IFC) is a **member of the World Bank Group** that focuses on private sector development in developing countries.
It was **established in 1956**, with the objective to promote economic development by supporting private enterprises and investment in emerging and developing economies.
Statement I is correct. India has the largest share of investment in the IFC portfolio followed by Brazil.
IFC's total portfolio exposure to India is over $10 billion, making India the largest recipient of funding from the international financial institution.

IFC'S LARGEST COUNTRY EXPOSURES[8]
AS OF JUNE 30, 2025 (BASED ON IFC'S ACCOUNT)

GLOBAL COUNTRY RANK		PORTFOLIO EXPOSURE[7] ($ MILLIONS)	% OF GLOBAL PORTFOLIO
1	India	10,319	11.38%
2	Brazil	7,145	7.88%
3	Türkiye	5,583	6.16%
4	South Africa	4,002	4.42%
5	China	3,084	3.40%

Statement II is incorrect. IFC is the **private-sector arm of the World Bank** Group and **lends exclusively to the private sector**.

IFC does not lend directly to micro, small, and medium enterprises or individual entrepreneurs.

Knowledge Base: **World Bank Group**

- The World Bank Group is a group of five international organizations that provide loans, grants, and financial assistance to developing countries.
- Headquarters: Washington, D.C., United States
- The World Bank was created in 1944 at the Bretton Woods Conference along with the IMF.

The World Bank Group consists of the following five institutions:

- International Bank for Reconstruction and Development (IBRD)- Established: 1944
- International Development Association (IDA)- Established: 1960
- International Finance Corporation (IFC) - Established: 1956
- International Centre for Settlement of Investment Disputes (ICSID) - Established: 1965. **India is not a member of the International Centre for Settlement of Investment Disputes (ICSID)**
- Multilateral Investment Guarantee Agency (MIGA) - Established: 1988

Source:) https://www.worldbank.org/en/about/annual-report/ifc
https://www.worldbank.org/en/about/annual-report/ifc?dropid=fiscal
Subject:) Economy
Topic:) Global finance Architecture
Subtopic:)

Q.20) The Wildlife Institute of India conducted the first-ever comprehensive population estimation of riverine dolphins in India. Which of the following is/are correct regarding the findings of this survey?
I. Uttar Pradesh has the highest number of Gangetic Dolphins among all the States in India.
II. The population density of Gangetic Dolphins is highest in Yamuna River.
III. Sutlej is the only river in India in which Indus River Dolphins were found.
Select the correct answer using the code given below:
a) I only
b) I and II
c) III only
d) I and III

Ans) a

Exp) Option a is the correct answer.

The Government recently released the results of the first-ever comprehensive population estimation of riverine dolphins – Gangetic and Indus dolphins – done in India. The Wildlife Institute of India, under the Union Environment Ministry, conducted this first-ever comprehensive population estimation survey of river dolphins in India between 2021 and 2023.

Statement I is correct. The survey estimated the total population of Gangetic dolphins to be 6,324, with a range between 5,977 and 6,688 individuals. **The highest number of Gangetic dolphins was found in Uttar Pradesh**, with 2,397 individuals. Bihar followed closely with 2,220 dolphins, while West Bengal recorded 815.

Statement II is incorrect. The survey identified certain stretches of rivers where dolphin populations were either abundant (hotspots) or sparse (coldspots). The Narora-Kanpur stretch in Uttar Pradesh was one of the coldspots, with an encounter rate of just 0.1 dolphins per kilometer. **Other coldspots included the Yamuna River (Kaushambi-Chitrakoot), the Sharda River in Pilibhit, and the Rapti River from Balrampur to Sidhharth Nagar.**

Some stretches had a high density of dolphins. In Bihar, the Chausa-Manihar stretch spanning 590 kilometers had an encounter rate of 2.20 dolphins per kilometer, while the stretch between Manihari in Bihar and Rajmahal in Jharkhand recorded an even higher encounter rate of 2.75 dolphins per kilometer. These areas were identified as key habitats for the species.

Statement III is incorrect. The study also found **only three Indus River dolphins; all located in the Beas River in Punjab.** Punjab was the only state where Indus River dolphins were recorded, with a count of three individuals in the Beas River.

Source: SFG ESSENTIAL, CURRENT AFFAIRS, QUARTERLY COMPILATION (JANUARY– MARCH 2025)
Subject:) Current Affairs
Topic:) Environment
Subtopic:)

Q.21) Consider the following statements:
1. India is a member of the International Grains Council.
2. A country needs to be a member of the International Grains Council for exporting or importing rice and wheat.
Which of the statements given above is/are correct?
a) 1 only
b) 2 only
c) Both 1 and 2
d) Neither 1 nor 2

Ans) a
Exp) Option a is the correct answer.
Statement 1 is correct: The International Grains Council (IGC) is an intergovernmental organization which oversees the Grains Trade Convention and seeks to promote cooperation in the global grain trade. **India is one of the members of IGC.**
Statement 2 is incorrect: Currently, only 30 countries are members of the IGC. **There is no such mandate under the council for a country to be a member of IGC to export or import rice and wheat.** Countries such as Russia, Ukraine, Afghanistan, etc. are not the members of the IGC and yet they actively do import and export of the grains.
Source: UPSC CSE Pre 2024
Subject:) Economy
Topic:) Global finance Architecture
Subtopic:)

Q.22) Which of the following factors may lead to appreciation of the Indian rupee?
I. Reserve Bank of India selling US Dollars in the domestic market.
II. Foreign investors pulling out funds from Indian markets.
III. Increase in investments in masala bonds which is a rupee denominated bond issued outside India.
IV. Lower inflation in India compared to other countries.
Select the correct answer using the code given below:
a) I and IV only
b) II and III only
c) I, III and IV only
d) I, II, III and IV

Ans) c
Exp) Option c is the correct answer.
Option I is correct: When the RBI sells US dollars in the forex market, it increases the supply of dollars and absorbs rupees, which helps strengthen the rupee **thus, leading to appreciation of the Indian rupee.**
Option II is incorrect: When **foreign investors withdraw their investments**, they sell Indian assets and convert their holdings into foreign currencies, **increasing the demand for the dollar and weakening the rupee.**
Option III is correct: Increase in investments in masala bonds abroad implies **more rupee will be demanded by the investors** to subscribe to these bonds. It will lead to an increase in the demand of rupee and ultimately, **rupee will appreciate.** Masala Bonds are rupee-denominated bonds issued outside India by Indian entities. They are debt instruments which help to raise money in local currency from foreign investors.
Option IV is correct: Lower inflation in India compared to other countries strengthens the rupee which may result in rupee appreciation while higher inflation reduces purchasing power, leading to depreciation.

Source:) https://documents.worldbank.org/en/publication/documents-reports/documentdetail/872041468044088310
https://indianexpress.com/article/explained/explained-economics/rupees-dollar-trade-fdi-rbi-10403904/
https://www.thehindu.com/business/markets/why-is-the-rupee-weakening-against-the-dollar-explained/article69062461.ece
Subject:) Economy
Topic:) External Sector
Subtopic:)

Q.23) The Asia Power Index, an index that distinguishes between resources (what countries possess) and influence (how effectively those resources are translated into regional outcomes) is published/released by:
a) Asian Development Bank
b) World Economic Forum
c) Lowy Institute
d) The Institute of South Asian Studies

Ans) c
Exp) Option c is the correct answer
India has secured third ranking in the Asia Power Index 2025, while the U.S. and China occupy the first and second spots. **Australia-based think tank, Lowy Institute, releases/publishes its annual Asia Power Index,** which assesses the ability of nations, particularly of those in the Asian continent, to influence their external environment.
The Index distinguishes between resources (what countries possess) and influence (how effectively those resources are translated into regional outcomes). It also introduces the concept of a Power Gap, which measures the divergence between a country's expected influence based on its resources and its realised influence.
Source: https://www.indiabudget.gov.in/economicsurvey/doc/eschapter/echap16-1.pdf (Page 647)
https://www.newsonair.gov.in/india-secures-third-rank-in-asia-power-index-2025/
Subject:) Economy
Topic:) Global finance Architecture
Subtopic:)

Q.24) It is an economic concept that reflects the conflict between the short-term domestic policies and long-term international responsibility for countries whose currencies serve as global reserve currencies.
Which of the following dilemmas/paradox have been explained above?
a) Lucas paradox
b) Bertrand paradox
c) Triffin paradox or dilemma
d) Leontief paradox

Ans) c
Exp) Option c is the correct answer.
Option c is correct: The Triffin dilemma, or Triffin's paradox, is the **conflict of economic interests that arises between short-term domestic policies and long-term international policies for countries whose currencies serve as global reserve currencies.** The Triffin dilemma was first identified by economist Robert Triffin in the 1960s.

- **If the United States stopped running** balance of payments **deficits, the international community would lose its largest source of additions to reserves.** The resulting shortage of liquidity could pull the world economy into a contractionary spiral, leading to instability.
- If U.S. deficits continued, a steady stream of dollars would continue to fuel world economic growth. However, **excessive U.S. deficits (dollar glut) would erode confidence in the value of the U.S. dollar.** Without confidence in the dollar, it would no longer be accepted as the world's reserve currency. The fixed exchange rate system could break down, leading to instability.

Knowledge Base: **Impossible Trinity:** Also known as Mundell -Fleming trilemma, it refers to the idea that **an economy cannot pursue independent monetary policy, maintain a fixed exchange rate, and allow the free flow of capital**

across its borders **at the same time.** Any economy can choose to pursue only two out of the three policy options simultaneously in the long-run.

Leontief Paradox: Despite being capital-abundant and labor scared, a country exports labor-intensive goods and imports capital-intensive goods. For example, the USA.

Source:)https://www.imf.org/external/np/exr/center/mm/eng/mm_sc_03.htm#:~:text=Triffin's%20Dilemma,source%20of%20additions%20to%20reserves.

https://indianexpress.com/article/opinion/columns/navigating-economic-uncertainties-caused-by-ukraine-war-7807512/

https://www.thehindu.com/business/Economy/the-impossible-trinity/article65973261.ece

https://egyankosh.ac.in/bitstream/123456789/90046/3/Unit-4.pdf (Pg. 78 - 79)

https://www.thehindubusinessline.com/opinion/magas-leontief-problem/article69944740.ece

Subject:) Economy

Topic:) Global finance Architecture

Subtopic:)

Q.25) With reference to the cultivation of genetically modified crops in India, consider the following statements:

Statement I: In the recent past, there has been an increasing demand for the Bollgard-3 variety of cotton by farmers of Punjab.

Statement II: The use of the Bollgard-3 variety for cotton cultivation in some of the other States in India have shown remarkable success.

Statements III: Bollgard-3 is a pest-resistant genetically-modified (GM) variety of cotton that shows remarkable resistance to pests.

Which one of the following is correct in respect of the statements given above?

a) Both statement II and statement III are correct and both of them explain statement I.

b) Both statement II and statement III are correct, but only one of them explains statement I.

c) Only one of the statements II and III is correct, and that explains statement I.

d) Neither Statement II nor statement III is correct.

Ans) c

Exp) Option c is the correct answer.

Bollgard-3 is a new pest-resistant genetically-modified (GM) cotton variety. It was developed by Monsanto more than a decade ago, and shows remarkable resistance to pests.

Statement I is correct. In the recent past, **there has been an increasing demand for Bollgard-3,** a pest-resistant cotton variety, in Punjab.

Statement II is incorrect. The Bollgard-3 variety is yet to become available in India.

Bollgard-1 was a Monsanto-developed Bt cotton introduced in India in 2002, followed by Bollgard-2 in 2006. The latter remains prevalent today. Bollgard-3 is not available in India at the moment, although it is being used in other cotton-growing countries around the world.

Statement III is correct. In recent years, whiteflies and pink bollworms have wreaked havoc on the cotton crop in North India. Cotton yields are down, as is the area under cotton cultivation in Punjab. Ahead of the cotton sowing season, farmers are thus **calling for the swift approval of Bollgard-3, a new pest-resistant genetically-modified (GM) cotton variety** developed by Monsanto. It **shows remarkable resistance to pests.**

It contains three Bt proteins Cry1Ac, Cry2Ab and Vip3A that cause insect death by disrupting their normal gut function. This in turn allows for the growth of a healthier cotton crop, and increases yield.

Farmers are demanding the introduction of Bollgard-3, because it is particularly effective against lepidopteran pests like pink bollworm.

Source: SFG ESSENTIAL, CURRENT AFFAIRS, QUARTERLY COMPILATION (JANUARY– MARCH 2025)

Subject:) Current Affairs

Topic:) Science & Technology

Subtopic:)

Q.26) With reference to Trade Related Investment Measures (TRIMS), which of the following statements is/are correct?
1. Quantitative restrictions on imports by foreign investors are prohibited.
2. They apply to investment measures related to trade in both goods and services.
3. They are not concerned with the regulation of foreign investment.
Select the correct answer using the code given below:
a) 1 and 2 only
b) 2 only
c) 1 and 3 only
d) 1, 2 and 3

Ans) c
Exp) Option c is the correct answer
The Agreement on Trade-Related Investment Measures (TRIMS) recognizes that certain investment measures can restrict and distort trade. It states that WTO members may not apply any measure that discriminates against foreign products or that leads to quantitative restrictions, both of which violate basic WTO principles.
Statements 1 and 3 are correct. The Agreement on Trade - Related Investment Measures (TRIMS) is a mechanism within WTO which seeks to promote foreign investment and remove quantitative restrictions, which distort trade. **It is not directly concerned with the regulation of foreign investments.** Instead, it focuses on investment measures that affect trade in goods, ensuring that they do not create barriers to international trade.
Statement 2 is incorrect. They apply only to goods, not Services.
Source: UPSC CSE Pre 2020

Q.27) With reference to Eligible Manufacturer Importers (EMIs) Scheme, consider the following statements:
I. It was launched by the Central Board of Indirect Taxes and Customs.
II. Under it, Eligible Manufacturer Importers will be able to clear imported goods without paying Customs duty at the time of clearance.
Which of the statements given above is/are correct?
a) I only
b) II only
c) Both I and II
d) Neither I nor II

Ans) c
Exp) Option c is the correct answer.
Statement I is correct: Eligible Manufacturer Importers (EMIs) Scheme **was launched by the Central Board of Indirect Taxes and Customs for manufacturers** to delay payment of customs duty on imported goods, easing pressure on their working capital.
Statement II is correct: Under this initiative, a new category known **as Eligible Manufacturer Importers (EMIs) has been created.** These importers are **allowed to clear imported goods at ports without paying customs duty upfront. Instead, they can defer the payment of customs duty and pay it later on a monthly basis** in accordance with the Deferred Payment of Import Duty Rules, 2016.
Source:) https://economictimes.indiatimes.com/news/economy/policy/india-allows-eligible-manufacturers-to-defer-customs-duty-payments-from-april-1-aims-to-boost-liquidity-and-exports/articleshow/128906892.cms?from=mdr
Subject:) Economy
Topic:) External Sector
Subtopic:)

Q.28) In which of the following sectors, 100 percent foreign direct investment under automatic route is permitted in India?
I. Insurance Company

II. Marketplace model of e-commerce
III. Private Sector Banks
IV. Coal mining
Select the correct answer using the code given below:
a) I, II and III
b) I, II and IV
c) II and IV only
d) I, III and IV

Ans) b
Exp) Option b is the correct answer.
Option I is correct: The Sabka Bima Sabki Raksha (Amendment of Insurance Laws) Act, 2025 allows up to 100% Foreign Direct Investment (FDI) in insurance companies. This reform is intended to attract greater foreign participation, leading to increased capital inflow, adoption of advanced technology, and the introduction of global best practices.
Option II is correct: The marketplace-based model of e-commerce refers to an arrangement where an e-commerce entity provides a digital or electronic platform that facilitates transactions between buyers and sellers without owning the inventory. **As per the FDI guidelines for the e-commerce sector, 100% FDI is permitted under the automatic route in the marketplace model. However FDI is not permitted in the inventory based model of e-commerce.**
Option III is incorrect: A foreign bank can operate in India through three channels: by establishing branches, by setting up a wholly-owned subsidiary**, or by creating a subsidiary in a private bank with aggregate foreign investment limited to a maximum of 74% (not 100%)**
Option IV is correct: 100% FDI under automatic route permitted for sale of coal and other coal mining activities including associated processing infrastructure like coal washery, crushing etc.
Source:) https://www.dpiit.gov.in/static/uploads/2025/07/bdcb2c6eda1dbc1f7c29981e4c3fd428.pdf
https://www.dpiit.gov.in/static/uploads/2026/02/4eddf849f19d658e3a74dc32d344b5f9.pdf
https://economictimes.indiatimes.com/industry/banking/finance/banking/india-holding-talks-to-raise-foreign-investment-cap-in-state-run-banks-to-49/articleshow/127854454.cms?from=mdr
Subject:) Economy
Topic:) Balance Of Payment
Subtopic:)

Q.29) Consider the following statements with reference to the Asian Infrastructure Investment Bank (AIIB):
I. India is the second-largest shareholder in the bank.
II. India is the largest borrower country from the bank in terms of total loan value.
III. Membership in the bank is open only to countries located in Asia.
Which of the statements given above are correct?
a) I and III only
b) II and III only
c) I and II only
d) I, II and III

Ans) c
Exp) Option c is the correct answer.
The **Asian Infrastructure Investment Bank (AIIB)** is a multilateral development bank that finances infrastructure and sustainable development projects mainly in Asia and other regions.
It began operations in **2016 and is headquartered in Beijing**, China.
It has an **authorized capital of USD 100 billion.**
In 2018, AIIB was granted **Permanent Observer status** in both the United Nations General Assembly and the Economic and Social Council.

Statement III is incorrect. The bank currently has 111 members, including 6 prospective members from around the world- 42 from Asia, 26 from Europe, 22 from Africa, 10 from Oceania, 9 from South America, and 2 from North America.

Statement I is correct. China has the largest shareholder (26.3642%) followed by **India in 2nd place (7.5268%)** with Russia in the 3rd place (5.9160%).

Statement II is correct. Currently India is the largest borrower from the bank. ($10 billion) as of 2025.

Source:) https://www.aiib.org/en/about-aiib/governance/members-of-bank/index.html
https://economictimes.indiatimes.com/news/economy/finance/aiib-sees-india-exposure-growing-to-usd-20-bn-in-5-yrs-from-usd-12-bn/articleshow/123019696.cms?from=mdr
Subject:) Economy
Topic:) Global finance Architecture
Subtopic:)

Q.30) Which of the following statements is/are correct with respect to GARBH-INi-DRISHTI that was recently seen in the news?
I. It is an initiative of the Ministry of Health and Family Welfare of the Government of India.
II. It is an antenatal care facility for pregnant women that focuses on adequate physical and emotional development.
Select the correct answer using the code given below
a) I only
b) II only
c) Both I and II
d) Neither I nor II

Ans) d
Exp) Option d is the correct answer.
Statement I is incorrect. GARBH-INi-DRISHTI is an initiative of the **Department of Biotechnology (DBT)**, under the **Ministry of Science and Technology.**
Statement II is incorrect. It is **a data dashboard that provides a comprehensive overview of one of South Asia's largest pregnancy cohort datasets.** This groundbreaking platform, developed under the GARBH-INi program, provides access to an unprecedented **wealth of clinical data, images, and biospecimens** collected from over 12,000 pregnant women, newborns, and postpartum mothers. It will empower researchers worldwide to conduct transformative research aimed at improving maternal and neonatal health outcomes.
Source: SFG ESSENTIAL, CURRENT AFFAIRS, QUARTERLY COMPILATION (JANUARY– MARCH 2025)
Subject:) Current Affairs
Topic:) Science & Technology
Subtopic:)

Q.31) "Gold Tranche" (Reserve Tranche) refers to
a) a loan system of the World Bank
b) one of the operations of a Central Bank
c) a credit system granted by WTO to its members
d) a credit system granted by IMF to its members

Ans) d
Exp) Option d is the correct answer
Option d is correct. Gold tranche, also known as reserve tranche, represents a part of a member country's quota with the International Monetary Fund (IMF) that exists in the form of gold or foreign currency. For any member country, 25% of the total quota should be paid in the form of gold or foreign currency. This is why it is called reserve tranche or gold tranche.
Source: UPSC CSE Pre 2020
Subject:) Economy
Topic:) External Sector

Subtopic:)

Q.32) Consider the following regional economic groupings:
I. Indo-Pacific Economic Framework (IPEF)
II. Asia-Pacific Economic Cooperation (APEC)
III. Regional Comprehensive Economic Partnership (RCEP)
In how many of the above groupings, India is a member?
a) Only one
b) Only two
c) All the three
d) None

Ans) a
Exp) Option a is the correct answer.
Option I is correct: The Indo-Pacific Economic Framework for Prosperity was launched on 23 May 2022 in Tokyo by the United States and other partner countries of the Indo-Pacific region. It aims to strengthen economic engagement among partner countries to advance growth, peace, and prosperity in the region. The framework currently has **14 partner countries including India.**
Option II is incorrect: The Asia-Pacific Economic Cooperation is a regional economic forum established in 1989 to leverage the growing interdependence of the Asia-Pacific region. At present, APEC has 21 member economies, including the United States, China, Japan, Australia, and Russia. **However, India is not a member of APEC.**
Option III is incorrect: The Regional Comprehensive Economic Partnership (RCEP) is a comprehensive free trade agreement signed in 2020 among the **10 ASEAN countries and five of their FTA partners–Australia, China, Japan, South Korea, and New Zealand**. Although **India** participated in negotiations, it **withdrew from the agreement in 2019** due to various concerns.
Source:)
https://www.commerce.gov.in/press-releases/indo-pacific-economic-framework-for-prosperity-ipef-supply-chain-agreement-signed-by-the-14-ipef-partners/
https://www.commerce.gov.in/international-trade/trade-agreements/indias-current-engagements-in-rtas/brief-on-regional-comprehensive-economic-partnership-rcep/
https://www.apec.org/about-us/about-apec
Subject:) Economy
Topic:) External Sector
Subtopic:)

Q.33) Which one of the following best describes the primary function of the Paris Club or Club de Paris?
a) Formulating standards for stablecoins used in international transactions.
b) Supporting encrypted messaging services for financial transactions.
c) Promoting a borderless trade regime among countries.
d) Coordinating debt relief and restructuring for countries facing financial difficulties.

Ans) d
Exp) Option d is the correct answer.
The **Paris Club** is an **informal group of creditor countries** established in **1956** and headquartered in **Paris**. It works collectively to **support countries facing financial difficulties**, particularly those struggling to repay their external debts. The Paris Club originated from a meeting held in Paris in 1956 when Argentina agreed to meet its public creditors.
The **Paris Club helps countries tide over financial difficulties**. Countries facing financial constraints and unable to meet their debt repayment deadlines can approach the Paris Club for support in mediating with creditor countries. The club provides debt treatment to countries. This includes:

- negotiating new terms for the loan,
- extending repayment deadlines,

- having the owed amount reduced, and
- cancelling some of the debt owed

This provides nations in debt with a communication channel with their lenders with mediators present. This has been a relatively successful approach for the Paris Club as club members have generally been the creditors of debts accrued by developing nations.

Source:) https://www.business-standard.com/world-news/the-paris-club-here-is-all-you-need-to-know-about-the-group-of-creditors-123061500600_1.html

Subject:) Economy

Topic:) Global finance Architecture

Subtopic:)

Q.34) With reference to Minerals Security Partnership, consider the following statements:

I. It is an initiative launched by the United States of America.

II. The Minerals Security Finance Network has been established under it to facilitate financing for critical mineral supply chains.

III. India is a member of the Minerals Security Partnership.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

a) I and II only

b) III only

c) I and III only

d) I, II and III

Ans) d

Exp) Option d is the correct answer.

The Minerals Security Partnership (MSP) was officially announced in June 2022 in Toronto, Canada, on the margins of the Prospectors and Developers Association of Canada (PDAC) convention, which is regarded as the largest mining event in the world. The partnership aims to strengthen and secure global supply chains for critical minerals that are essential for modern technologies and clean energy transitions.

Statement I is correct: The initiative was launched under the leadership of the United States, with several founding partners including Australia, Canada, Finland, France, the United Kingdom, and the European Commission etc.

Statement II is correct: The partner governments of the Minerals Security Partnership (MSP) announced the establishment of the **Minerals Security Partnership Finance Network (MSP Finance Network).** This network is intended to strengthen cooperation among participating financial institutions and promote information exchange and co-financing to advance diverse, secure, and sustainable supply chains for critical minerals.

Statement III is correct: India has become 14th member of the Mineral Security Partnership (MSP) in June 2023. The other member countries are the United States, Australia, Canada, Finland, France, Germany, Italy, Japan, Norway, the Republic of Korea, Sweden, the United Kingdom and the European Commission.

Source:) https://www.iea.org/policies/16066-minerals-security-partnership

https://www.pib.gov.in/PressReleaseIframePage.aspx?PRID=1946416&reg=3&lang=2

https://2021-2025.state.gov/joint-statement-on-establishment-of-the-minerals-security-partnership-finance-network/

Subject:) Economy

Topic:) External Sector

Subtopic:)

Q.35) The Defence Research and Development Organisation (DRDO) recently demonstrated a cutting-edge "active cooled scramjet combustor ground test" for 120 seconds for the first time in India. In this context, consider the following statements regarding the Scramjet Technology:

I. Unlike traditional rocket engines, Scramjet engines do not use oxygen from the atmosphere for combustion of fuels.

II. Unlike conventional jet engines, Scramjet engines do not have any rotating compressors.

III. Scramjet engines can work efficiently at hypersonic speeds.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

a) III only
b) II only
c) II and III only
d) I, II and III

Ans) c
Exp) Option c is the correct answer.
Statement I is incorrect. A Supersonic Combustion Ramjet (Scramjet) engine is an advanced air-breathing jet engine designed to operate at extremely high speeds. **Scramjets do not have rotating compressors, instead they rely on the forward motion of the aircraft to compress incoming air.**
Scramjet engines use oxygen from the atmosphere for combustion of hydrogen fuel, which means they rely on atmospheric oxygen as the oxidizer. This distinguishes them from **traditional rocket engines, which do not use oxygen from the atmosphere** for combustion of fuels.
Statement II is correct. Supersonic combustion ramjets, or Scramjets, operate by burning fuel in a stream of supersonic air compressed by the forward speed of the aircraft. **Unlike conventional jet engines, scramjets have no rotating compressors.** In normal jet engines, rotating blades compress the air, and the airflow remains sub-sonic. **Scramjets do not have rotating compressors**, instead they rely on the forward motion of the aircraft to compress incoming air.
Statement III is correct. A scramjet engine is an improvement over the ramjet engine as **it efficiently operates at hypersonic speeds and** allows supersonic combustion. Thus it is known as Supersonic Combustion Ramjet, or Scramjet.
Ramjets work most efficiently at supersonic speeds around Mach 3 (three times the speed of sound) and can operate up to speeds of Mach 6. However, the ramjet efficiency starts to drop when the vehicle reaches hypersonic speeds.
Source: SFG ESSENTIAL, CURRENT AFFAIRS, QUARTERLY COMPILATION (JANUARY– MARCH 2025)
Subject:) Current Affairs
Topic:) Science & Technology
Subtopic:)

Q.36) Consider the following reports:
I. Global Estimates on International Migrant Workers
II. World Economic Situation and Prospects Report
III. The Future of Jobs Report
IV. The Global Cybersecurity Outlook
How many of the reports given above are released by the World Economic Forum?
a) Only one
b) Only two
c) Only three
d) All the four

Ans) b
Exp) Option b is the correct answer.
Option I is incorrect: The 'Global Estimates on International Migrant Workers' is released by the International Labour Organization.
Option II is incorrect: The **'World Economic Situation and Prospects Report'** is prepared by the United Nations Department of Economic and Social Affairs in collaboration with the United Nations Conference on Trade and Development and the **five UN regional commissions**.
Option III is correct: The Future of Jobs Report 2025 is released by the World Economic Forum that brings together the perspective of over 1,000 leading global employers collectively representing more than 14 million workers across 22 industry clusters and 55 economies from around the world. The report examines how these macrotrends impact jobs and skills, and the workforce transformation strategies employers plan to embark on in response, across the 2025 to 2030 timeframe.

Option IV is correct: The Global Cybersecurity Outlook 2026, released by the World Economic Forum in collaboration with Accenture, examines the cybersecurity trends that will affect economies and societies in the year to come. The report explores how accelerating AI adoption, geopolitical fragmentation and widening cyber inequity are reshaping the global risk landscape.

Source:) http://thehindu.com/news/international/what-did-the-ilo-report-state-about-international-migrants-explained/article69117229.ece
https://indianexpress.com/article/upsc-current-affairs/upsc-essentials/knowledge-nugget-upsc-un-world-economic-situation-report-2026-10463799/
https://reports.weforum.org/docs/WEF_Future_of_Jobs_Report_2025.pdf
https://www.weforum.org/publications/global-cybersecurity-outlook-2026/
Subject:) Economy
Topic:) Global finance Architecture
Subtopic:)

Q.37) With reference to the India-European Union (EU) Free Trade Agreement, consider the following statements:
I. The agreement provides the EU with immediate duty elimination for over 97% of its total export value to the India market.
II. The EU has excluded items such as sugar and tobacco from tariff concessions.
III. The trade deal requires India and the EU to have the same labour and environmental laws.
Which of the statements given above is/are correct?
a) I and II only
b) II only
c) I and III only
d) None of the above

Ans) b
Exp) Option b is the correct answer.
Joint India-EU Comprehensive Strategic Agenda, endorsed at the 16th **India-EU Summit held in January 2026 in New Delhi,** aims to further reinforce the strategic partnership by broadening, deepening and better coordinating EU-India cooperation to deliver mutually beneficial, concrete and transformative outcomes for both partners and for the wider world. **The India- European Union Free Trade Agreement was signed as part of the agenda.**
Statement I is incorrect: Under the deal, India offers immediate duty-free access on about 49.6% of tariff lines covering 30.6% of trade value, and 39.5% tariff lines with trade value of 63.1% placed under phased elimination over 5/7/10 years from entry into force of the Agreement. **India's total offer covers around 92.1% of tariff lines and 97.5% of trade value,** reflecting a balanced strategy to open markets while protecting sensitive sectors.
Under the Agreement, the **EU has committed to eliminating duties on about 70.4% of tariff lines immediately**, **covering nearly 90.7% of India's export value in goods**, while another 20.3% of products will undergo phased tariff elimination.
Statement II is correct: The **EU has excluded sensitive agricultural products** such as meat and meat offal, dairy products, honey, rice, sugar, tobacco etc. **from tariff concessions**, meaning these items do not receive tariff liberalisation.
Similarly, **India has safeguarded sensitive sectors**, including beef and poultry, dairy products, fish and seafood, cereals (especially rice and wheat), fruits and vegetables, nuts, edible oils, tea, coffee, spices, tobacco etc.
Statement III is incorrect: The Trade and Sustainable Development (TSD) Chapter within the Trade deal aims to enhance the integration of sustainable development, specifically its environmental and social (labour) dimensions, within the trade relationship between India and the EU. **It explicitly states that it is not the intention of India and the EU to harmonise their labour or environment standards.** Each of them retains the right to regulate and determine its own sustainable development policies, priorities, and levels of domestic protection.
Source:)
https://www.pib.gov.in/PressReleasePage.aspx?PRID=2220413&reg=3&lang=2 (Q. 2, 3, 5 and 43)
https://www.commerce.gov.in/wp-content/uploads/2026/01/Factsheet-on-India-EU-trade-deal-27.1.2026.pdf

Subject:) Economy
Topic:) External Sector
Subtopic:)

Q.38) With reference to International Monetary Fund, consider the following statements:
I. It facilitates the expansion of international trade and economic growth.
II. More than 75% of its funds comes through Bilateral Borrowing Agreements (BBAs) with the member countries.
III. Global Financial Stability Report is published by IMF.
Which of the statements given above is/are correct?
a) I and II
b) II only
c) II and III
d) I and III

Ans) d
Exp) Option d is the correct answer.
The International Monetary Fund aims to promote sustainable growth and prosperity among its 191 member countries by supporting economic policies that ensure financial stability and international monetary cooperation.
Statement I is correct: The I**nternational Monetary Fund has three key objectives**: promoting international monetary cooperation, f**acilitating the expansion of international trade and economic growth**, and discouraging policies that may undermine global prosperity. To achieve these goals, member countries cooperate with one another and work in coordination with other international institutions.
Statement II is incorrect: The International Monetary Fund mobilizes its financial resources from three main sources: member country quotas, multilateral credit arrangements, and bilateral borrowing agreements. Among these, **quota contributions from member countries constitute the primary source of funding.** The multilateral and **bilateral borrowing arrangements act as supplementary resource**s, enabling the IMF to strengthen its lending capacity and support member countries during periods of financial crisis.

IMF Funding

Statement III is correct: The Global Financial Stability Report (GFSR) is published by the International Monetary Fund (IMF). This semiannual report assesses the health and stability of global financial markets. It highlights vulnerabilities that could potentially affect global financial systems and provides policy recommendations for mitigating risks.
Source:) https://www.imf.org/en/about/factsheets/imf-at-a-glance
https://www.imf.org/en/about/factsheets/imf-lending
https://www.imf.org/en/blogs/articles/2025/06/25/explainer-how-the-imf-finances-itself-and-why-it-matters-for-the-global-economy
Subject:) Economy
Topic:) Global finance Architecture
Subtopic:)

Q.39) With reference to core/fundamental International Labour Organisation (ILO) Conventions, consider the following:
I. Freedom of Association and Protection of the Right to Organise Convention, 1948 (No. 87)
II. Worst Forms of Child Labour Convention, 1999 (No. 182)
III. Minimum Age Convention, 1973 (No. 138)
IV. Right to Organise and Collective Bargaining Convention, 1949 (No.98)
Which of the above ILO conventions have been ratified by India?
a) I and IV only
b) II and III only
c) I, II and III only
d) I, II, III and IV

Ans) b
Exp) Option b is the correct answer
India is a founder member of the International Labour Organization (ILO), which came into existence in 1919. The principal means of action in the ILO is the setting up of International standards in the form of Conventions, Recommendations and Protocol.
India has ratified six out of the eight core/fundamental International Labour Organisation (ILO) Conventions.
The conventions that India has ratified include:

- Forced Labour Convention, 1930 (No. 29)
- Abolition of Forced Labour Convention, 1957 (No. 105)
- Equal Remuneration Convention, 1951 (No. 100)
- Discrimination (Employment and Occupation) Convention, 1958 (No. 111)
- **Minimum Age Convention, 1973 (No. 138) (Option III is correct)**
- **Worst Forms of Child Labour Convention, 1999 (No. 182). (Option II is correct)**

The two fundamental conventions of ILO – **Minimum Age Convention (No 138) c**oncerns minimum age for admission to employment **and Worst Form of Child Labour Convention (No 182)** concerns prohibition and immediate action for elimination of the worst form of Child labour.
The core/fundamental Conventions that India has not ratified include:

- **Freedom of Association and Protection of Right to Organise Convention,1948(No.87)**
- **Right to Organise and Collective Bargaining Convention,1949 (No.98)**

The primary reason for non -ratification of ILO Conventions No.87 and 98 is due to certain restrictions imposed on Government servants. The ratification of these Conventions would involve granting of certain rights that are prohibited under the statutory rules for the Government employees, namely to strike, to openly criticize Government policies, to freely accept financial contributions etc.
Source:) https://www.pib.gov.in/newsite/PrintRelease.aspx?relid=168889&reg=3&lang=2
https://indianexpress.com/article/india/cabinet-approves-2-ilo-conventions-on-prohibiting-child-labour/
Subject:) Economy
Topic:) Global finance Architecture
Subtopic:)

Q.40) The 'Blue Line' is a border demarcation frequently discussed in the context of:
a) Israel and Jordan
b) Israel and Lebanon
c) Egypt and Sudan
d) Syria and Turkey

Ans) b
Exp) Option b is the correct answer
The Blue Line is the border withdrawal line published by the United Nations between Israel and Lebanon. It is currently monitored by the United Nations Interim Force in Lebanon (UNIFIL).
Source: ForumIAS Current Affairs Class notes

Subject:) Current Affairs
Topic:) International Relations
Subtopic:)

Q.41) Which of the following statements are correct about the composition of the G-20?
1. All G-7 countries are members of G-20
2. All BRICS countries are members of G-20
3. All ASEAN countries are members of G-20
4. All permanent members of Security Council are members of G-20
Select the answer using the code given below:
a) 1, 2 and 3
b) 2 and 4 only
c) 1 and 4
d) 2, 3 and 4

Ans) c
Exp) Option c is the correct answer
The **Group of Twenty** (G20) is an **intergovernmental forum comprising the world's major developed and emerging economies.** It was **established in 1999 in the wake of the Asian financial crisis** as a meeting of Finance Ministers and Central Bank Governors.
G20 Member Countries:

- The **G20 consists of 19 individual countries, European Union (EU) and the African Union as the 21st member**.
- The countries are Argentina, Australia, Brazil, Canada, China, France, Germany, India, Indonesia, Italy, Japan, Mexico, Russia, Saudi Arabia, South Africa, South Korea, Turkey, the United Kingdom, and the United States.

Statement 1 is correct: The **G7 includes**: USA, UK, France, Germany, Italy, Canada and Japan
All these 7 countries are also members of the G20.
Statement 2 is incorrect: BRICS has expanded and now includes 10 full members: Initially comprising Brazil, Russia, India, China, and South Africa, the bloc expanded following the 2023 BRICS summit, which formally invited Egypt, Ethiopia, Iran, and the United Arab Emirates to join. In 2025, Indonesia became a full member, further enhancing the group's global influence.
Of these, only six countries are in the G20: Brazil, Russia, India, China, South Africa, and Indonesia
But **Egypt, Ethiopia, Iran, and the UAE are not members of the G20**
Statement 3 is incorrect: ASEAN has 10 member states: Indonesia, Malaysia, Thailand, Singapore, Vietnam, Brunei, Philippines, Myanmar, Cambodia, Laos and Timor-Leste
Among these, only Indonesia is a member of the G20.
Statement 4 is correct: The **five permanent members (P5) of the UN Security Council are: United States of America, United Kingdom, France, Russia and China**
All five are members of the G20
Source: UPSC CAPF 2024
Subject:) Economy
Topic:) Global finance Architecture
Subtopic:)

Q.42) With reference to World Trade Organization, consider the following statements about Most Favored Nation principle:
Statement I: A Free Trade Agreement (FTA) between two countries is considered a violation of the Most Favored Nation principle.
Statement II: The Most Favored Nation principle requires a member country to treat all other WTO members equally in matters of trade concessions.
Which one of the following is correct in respect of the above statements?

a) Both Statement I and Statement II are correct and Statement II explains Statement I
b) Both Statement I and Statement II are correct but Statement II does not explain Statement I
c) Statement I is correct but Statement II is not correct
d) Statement I is not correct but Statement II is correct

Ans) d
Exp) Option d is the correct answer.
The principle of "treating all trading partners equally" is known as the Most-Favoured-Nation (MFN) treatment, which is a fundamental rule of the World Trade Organization trading system.
Statement I is incorrect: Although the **Most Favored Nation principle** requires members not to discriminate between their trading partners, the World Trade Organization agreements permit certain exceptions. **One such exception is the formation of regional trade agreements such as Free Trade Agreements**, where member countries grant preferential treatment to each other while maintaining different tariffs for non-members.
Statement II is correct: Under the World Trade Organization agreements, countries cannot normally discriminate between their trading partners. If a country grants a special favour, such as a lower customs duty rate for one product, **it must extend the same treatment to all other World Trade Organization members.**
Source:) https://www.thehindu.com/news/explained-most-favoured-nation-status/article14847013.ece1
https://www.wto.org/english/thewto_e/whatis_e/tif_e/fact2_e.htm
Subject:) Economy
Topic:) Global finance Architecture
Subtopic:)

Q.43) In the context of Indian Economy, consider the following statements:
I. The Sovereign External Debt accounts for about 77 per cent of India's total external debt.
II. In terms of maturity, the long-term external debt constitutes around 80 per cent of the total external debt
III. In terms of the denomination of external debt, the Indian Rupee continued to be the largest component of India's external debt
Which of the statements given above is/are correct?
a) II and III only
b) II only
c) I, II and III
d) I and III only

Ans) b
Exp) Option b is the correct answer
At the end of March 2025, external debt stood at USD 736.3 billion, growing by 10.1 per cent (USD 67.5 billion) over the level a year ago. The external debt to GDP ratio was 19.1 per cent, while foreign exchange reserves to external debt ratio stood at 90.8 per cent as at end-March 2025.
Statement I is incorrect: The Sovereign External Debt (SED), accounts for about 23 per cent of the total external debt i.e. USD 168.4 billion. Non-sovereign external debt, accounts for the remaining 77 per cent of the total external debt i.e. USD 567.9 at the end of March 2025.
Statement II is correct: In terms of maturity, the long-term external debt constituted 81.7 per cent of the total, while the remaining 18.3 per cent was of short-term maturity.
Statement III is incorrect: In terms of the denomination of external debt, the US Dollar continued to be the largest component of India's external debt, with a share of 54.2 per cent at end-March 2025. Indian Rupee external debt occupied second place after US Dollar external debt at end-March 2025, with the share of 31.1 per cent in total external debt, followed by yen (6.2 per cent), SDR (4.6 per cent) and euro (3.2 per cent).
Source: https://dea.gov.in/files/external_debt_documents/Ex%20Debt%20Report%202024-25_Final.pdf (Page xii)
https://www.indiabudget.gov.in/economicsurvey/doc/eschapter/echap04.pdf (Page 199 and 200)
Subject:) Economy
Topic:) External Sector
Subtopic:)

Q.44) With reference to global infrastructure initiatives, consider the following pairs:

International infrastructure initiatives	Launched by
I. Blue Dot Network	Russia
II. Global Gateway Initiative	China
III. Partnership for Global Infrastructure and Investment	India

How many of the above pairs are correctly matched?
a) Only one
b) Only two
c) All the three
d) None

Ans) d
Exp) Option d is the correct answer.
Pair I is incorrect: The Blue Dot Network was jointly launched in 2019 by the United States, Japan, and Australia (not by Russia) to promote high-quality and sustainable infrastructure development worldwide. The initiative brings together governments, the private sector, and other stakeholders to promote internationally accepted quality standards in global infrastructure projects.
Pair II is incorrect: Global Gateway is the European Union's strategy (not the initiative of China) to boost smart, clean and secure connections in digital, energy and transport sectors, and to strengthen health, education and research systems across the world.
Pair III is incorrect: The Partnership for Global Infrastructure and Investment (PGII) is a shared G7 commitment (not India) to advance public and private investments in sustainable, inclusive, resilient and quality infrastructure. Through this partnership, the G7 aims to mobilize up to USD 600 billion by 2027 to narrow the infrastructure investment gap in partner countries.
Source:) https://www.mea.gov.in/rajya-sabha.htm?dtl/34825/QUESTION+NO100+BLUE+DOT+FRAMEWORK#:~:text=The%20Blue%20Dot%20Network%20is%20an%20initiative,local%20capital%20markets%2C%20and%20local%20capacity%20building
https://indianexpress.com/article/world/eu-unveils-300-billion-euro-answer-to-chinas-belt-and-road-7652106/
https://indianexpress.com/article/explained/everyday-explainers/india-europe-economic-corridor-pgii-explained-8933335/
Subject:) Economy
Topic:) Global finance Architecture
Subtopic:)

Q.45) The Government of India has recently announced the creation of a new National Gene Bank. In this context which of the statements given below is correct?
a) It would be the first ever Gene Bank to be created in India.
b) This Gene Bank would conserve about 10 lakh crop germplasm for future food and nutritional security in India.
c) It will be one of the initiatives under the theme "One Day One Genome" of the Union Budget 2025-26.
d) It will be established and managed by the National Biodiversity Authority.

Ans) b
Exp) Option b is the correct answer.
The Government of India has recently announced the creation of a Second National Gene Bank. The national gene bank is a facility that stores seeds of various crops, wild species and trees for future generation.
Statement a is incorrect. India's First National Gene Bank was established in 1996 by the Indian Council of Agricultural Research – National Bureau of Plant Genetic Resources (ICAR-NBPGR) in New Delhi.

Statement b is correct. The Government of India has recently **announced the establishment of India's Second National Gene Bank to conserve 10 lakh crop germplasm** for future food and nutritional security.
Statement c is incorrect. This announcement is one of the initiatives **under the theme "Investing in innovations" of Union Budget 2025-26.**
Statement d is incorrect. The National Gene Bank is managed by **ICAR – National Bureau of Plant Genetic Resources (NBPGR),** under the Ministry of Agriculture & Farmers' Welfare.
The National Bureau of Plant Genetic Resources (NBPGR) is the apex institution under ICAR responsible for plant genetic resource management.
Source: SFG ESSENTIAL, CURRENT AFFAIRS, QUARTERLY COMPILATION (JANUARY– MARCH 2025)
Subject:) Current Affairs
Topic:) Science & Technology
Subtopic:)

Q.46) With reference to Remission of Duties or Taxes on Exported Products (RoDTEP) scheme, consider the following statements:
I. It provides a mechanism for reimbursement of taxes, duties and levies, which are currently not being refunded under any other mechanism, at the central, state and local level, but which are incurred by the export entities in the process of manufacture and distribution of exported products.
II. Exporters of eligible items under the Scheme are being issued transferable electronic scrips as refund.
Which of the statements given above is/are correct?
a) I only
b) II only
c) Both I and II
d) Neither I nor II

Ans) c
Exp) Option c is the correct answer.
Statement I is correct: The Remission of Duties or Taxes on Exported Products (RoDTEP) scheme, launched in **2021**, provides for the **refund of taxes, duties, and levies incurred by exporters during the manufacture and distribution of exported goods** that are **not reimbursed under any other existing mechanism at the centre, state, or local level**.
Statement II is correct: Under the Remission of Duties and Taxes on Exported Products, eligible exporters receive **refunds in the form of electronic duty credit scrips (e-scrips)**. These **e-scrips are transferable** and can be used for the payment of Basic Customs Duty on imports.
Source:) https://www.thehindu.com/business/Industry/commerce-ministry-assures-of-restoration-of-full-rodtep-benefits-to-exporters-from-april-1-fieo/article70714972.ece
https://indiantradeportal.in/vs.jsp?lang=0&id=0,55,23222#:~:text=The%20benefit%20under%20the%20scheme%20can%20be%20claimed%20only%20in,of%20service%20exports%20outside%20India.
https://www.dgft.gov.in/CP/?opt=RODTEPARR
https://www.pib.gov.in/PressReleasePage.aspx?PRID=1961010&reg=3&lang=2#:~:text=different%20export%20sectors.-,The%20Committee%20held%20its%20first%20interaction%20today%20at%20Vanijya%20Bhawan,at%20the%208%20digit%20level.
Subject:) Economy
Topic:) External Sector
Subtopic:)

Q.47) Consider the following:
I. Anti-dumping duty
II. Local Content Requirement
III. Custom duty
IV. Import Quota
How many of the above can be considered as non-tariff barriers in International trade?

a) Only one
b) Only two
c) Only three
d) All the four

Ans) b

Exp) Option b is the correct answer

Non-tariff barriers are trade restrictions that **do not involve the imposition of taxes on imports** but still affect the volume of trade. In other words, Non-tariff barriers refer to **policy measures other than tariffs that restrict or distort international trade in goods and services.**

Within the framework of the World Trade Organisation, many Non -tariff barriers are regulated through specific agreements to ensure that they are not used to promote protectionism.

Option I is incorrect: Anti-dumping duty is considered as Tariff barriers to international trade. Anti dumping duty is a special import duty imposed by countries to offset dumping and protect their domestic industries from unfair price competition.

Option II is correct: Instead of placing a quota on the number of goods that can be imported, the government can require that a certain percentage of a good be made domestically (known as **Local Content Requirement)**. The restriction can be a percentage of the good itself or a percentage of the value of the good. **It is a non-tariff barrier in International trade.**

Option III is incorrect: Custom duty is considered as a tariff barrier to international trade. Custom Duty is a tax imposed by a government on goods that are imported into or exported out of the country. The basic purpose of imposing customs duty are Protection of Domestic industries, the regulation of trade etc.

Option IV is correct: Import **Quota is considered as non tariff barriers to international trade.** An import quota is a quantitative restriction on imports. Under it the government fixes the maximum amount of a product that can be imported within a given time.

Source:) https://www.wto.org/english/thewto_e/whatis_e/tif_e/agrm9_e.htm
Subject:) Economy
Topic:) Global finance Architecture
Subtopic:)

Q.48) Consider the following statements regarding the New Development Bank (NDB):
I. Only the Sovereign Governments can borrow from the Bank.
II. Presently, all the members of BRICS are members of the New Development Bank.
III. Each member country of the bank will have equal voting rights.
Which of the statements given above is/are correct?
a) I only
b) I and II only
c) III only
d) None of the above

Ans) d

Exp) Option d is the correct answer.

The **New Development Bank (NDB)** was **established in 2015** (**Headquarter in Shanghai**) by the then BRICS countries Brazil, Russia, India, China and South Africa to mobilise resources for infrastructure and sustainable development projects in emerging economies. Over time, the Bank has expanded its membership beyond the original five founding countries. **The countries become full members only after completing the accession process**.

Option I is incorrect: New Development Bank(NDB) is not restricted to borrowing only to sovereign governments. Its lending framework is broader and similar to other multilateral development Banks. Apart from National Government, Sub-National Government (State /Local Governments), Public Sector enterprises, Private Sector Entities and Financial Institutions can also borrow from NDB.

Option II is incorrect: The **members of NDB are** Brazil, Russia, India, China, South Africa, Bangladesh, UAE, Egypt, Algeria, Colombia and Uzbekistan.

BRICS members are - Brazil, Russia, India, China, South Africa, Egypt, Ethiopia, Iran, United Arab Emirates and Indonesia.

So, Ethiopia, Iran and Indonesia, which are members of BRICS, are not members of NDB.

Option III is incorrect: The voting power of each member shall equal its subscribed shares in the capital stock of the Bank. The founding members i.e. Brazil, Russia, China, India and South Africa will have equal voting powers as they have equal shares subscribed.

But the other members like Algeria, Bangladesh, UAE, Egypt have unequal voting powers and which depend on the shares subscribed by each countries.

Source:) https://www.ndb.int/about-ndb/members/ ; https://www.newsonair.gov.in/colombia-and-uzbekistan-join-ndb-ahead-of-17th-brics-summit/

https://www.ndb.int/wp-content/uploads/2022/11/Agreement-on-the-New-Development-Bank.pdf (Article 2)

Subject:) Economy

Topic:) Global finance Architecture

Subtopic:)

Q.49) Convertibility of rupee implies

a) being able to convert rupee notes into gold

b) allowing the value of rupee to be fixed by market forces

c) freely permitting the conversion of rupee to other currencies and vice versa.

d) developing an international market for currencies in India.

Ans) c

Exp) Option c is the correct answer

Option c is correct: Convertibility of rupee implies rupee can be converted into any foreign currency at the market determined rate of exchange and vice-versa.

Source: UPSC CSE Pre 2015

Subject:) Economy

Topic:) External Sector

Subtopic:)

Q.50) With reference to the satellite launch facilities in India, consider the following statements:

Statement I: The Third Launch Pad (TLP) of the Indian Space Research Organisation (ISRO) will be established at Sriharikota.

Statement II: The rotational speed of Earth increases as one moves from the Equator towards the poles.

Which one of the following is correct in respect of the above statements?

a) Both Statement I and Statement II are correct and Statement II explains Statement I

b) Both Statement I and Statement II are correct but Statement II does not explain Statement I

c) Statement I is correct but Statement II is not correct

d) Statement I is not correct but Statement II is correct

Ans) c

Exp) Option c is the correct answer.

Statement I is correct. The Union Cabinet recently approved the **establishment of the Third Launch Pad (TLP) at Satish Dhawan Space Centre of ISRO at Sriharikota,** Andhra Pradesh.

The Third Launch Pad project envisages the establishment of the launch infrastructure at Sriharikota, Andhra Pradesh for the Next Generation Launch Vehicles of ISRO. It also aims to support as standby launchpad for the Second Launch Pad at Sriharikota. This will also enhance the launch capacity for future Indian human spaceflight missions.The Project is of national importance.

As on today, Indian Space Transportation Systems are completely reliant on two launch pads viz. First Launch Pad (FLP) & Second Launch Pad (SLP), both at Sriharikota.

Statement II is incorrect: Sriharikota was selected as the site for the establishment of launch pad because:

- As it is located on the eastern coast of India, it enables launches in an easterly direction by taking advantage of earth's rotation.
- It is safer as it features uninhabited land and proximity to the sea for safer launches.
- **Its proximity to the Equator provides an extra boost for payloads. Earth's rotation from west to east is fastest at equator** that provides extra push leading to substantial increase in pay loads & cutting down the operational costs.
    - **The rotational speed of Earth decreases as one moves from the Equator towards the poles. Earth rotates faster at the Equator than it does at the poles**. Earth is wider at the Equator, so to make a rotation in one 24-hour period, equatorial regions race nearly 1,600 kilometers (1,000 miles) per hour. Near the poles, Earth rotates at a sluggish 0.00008 kilometers (0.00005 miles) per hour.

Source: SFG ESSENTIAL, CURRENT AFFAIRS, QUARTERLY COMPILATION (JANUARY– MARCH 2025)
Subject:) Current Affairs
Topic:) Science & Technology
Subtopic:)

Q.51) Let x be a positive integer such that 7x+ 96 is divisible by x. How many values of x are possible?
a) 10
b) 11
c) 12
d) Infinitely many

Ans) c
Exp) Option c is the correct answer.
For 7x + 96 to be divisible by x, x must be a factor of 96.
The factors of 96 are 1, 2, 3, 4, 6, 8, 12, 16, 24, 32, 48, and 96.
Therefore, there are 12 possible values of x.
Subject:) CSAT
Topic:) Quantitative Aptitude
Subtopic:)

Q.52) A natural number M is such that it can be expressed as M = a + b + c, where a, b, and c are three distinct proper factors of M, and none of them is 1. How many numbers below 60 have this property?
a) 6
b) 7
c) 8
d) 9

Ans) c
Exp) Option c is the correct answer.
M = a + b + c
where **a, b, c** are **distinct proper factors of M** and **a, b, c ≠ 1**.
For M divisible by 6, the proper factors **M/2, M/3, M/6** exist and are distinct.
(M/2) + (M/3) + (M/6)
= (3M/6) + (2M/6) + (M/6)
= 6M/6
= M
Also, **M/6 ≠ 1 ⇒ M ≠ 6**.
So valid M values are multiples of 6 below 60 excluding 6:
12, 18, 24, 30, 36, 42, 48, 54
12 = 2 + 4 + 6
18 = 3 + 6 + 9
24 = 4 + 8 + 12

30 = 5 + 10 + 15
36 = 6 + 12 + 18
42 = 7 + 14 + 21
48 = 8 + 16 + 24
54 = 9 + 18 + 27
Total numbers = 8
Subject:) CSAT
Topic:) Quantitative Aptitude
Subtopic:)

Q.53) Let a and b be prime numbers such that ($a^3 + b^2$) is also a prime number less than 100. What is the number of possible values of b?
a) 2
b) 3
c) 4
d) 5

Ans) a
Exp) Option a is the correct answer.
Given:
a and b are prime numbers and **$a^3 + b^2$ is a prime number less than 100**. Need the **number of possible values of b**.
Restrict possible values of a
Since **a is prime**, start with smallest primes:

I. If **a = 2**, then $a^3 = 8$
II. If **a = 3**, then $a^3 = 27$
III. If **a = 5**, then $a^3 = 125$, which is already **> 100**, so **$a^3 + b^2$ cannot be < 100**

So only **a = 2 or 3** are possible.
Restrict possible values of b
Since **b is prime** and we need **$a^3 + b^2 < 100$**:
Possible b values: 2, 3, 5, 7 (because $11^2 = 121$ already too large)
So test b ∈ {2, 3, 5, 7}.
Case 1: a = 2
$a^3 + b^2 = 8 + b^2$

I. b = 2 ⇒ 8 + 4 = 12 (not prime)
II. b = 3 ⇒ 8 + 9 = 17 (**prime**)
III. b = 5 ⇒ 8 + 25 = 33 (not prime)
IV. b = 7 ⇒ 8 + 49 = 57 (not prime)

So for a = 2, valid b = **3**.
Case 2: a = 3
$a^3 + b^2 = 27 + b^2$

I. b = 2 ⇒ 27 + 4 = 31 (**prime**)
II. b = 3 ⇒ 27 + 9 = 36 (not prime)
III. b = 5 ⇒ 27 + 25 = 52 (not prime)
IV. b = 7 ⇒ 27 + 49 = 76 (not prime)

So for a = 3, valid b = **2**.
Count distinct possible values of b
Valid b values are: **{2, 3}**
Number of possible values of b = **2**
Subject:) CSAT
Topic:) Quantitative Aptitude
Subtopic:)

Q.54) What comes at P and Q respectively in the following sequence?
March, March, February, December, P, May, December, Q, November
a) September, July
b) September, June
c) August, July
d) August, June

Ans) b
Exp) Option b is the correct answer.
Convert months into month numbers:
March = 3, February = 2, December = 12, May = 5, November = 11
Sequence becomes:
3, 3, 2, 12, P, 5, 12, Q, 11
The sequence moves **backward by 0, 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7 months** respectively.
3 → 3 : **−0**
3 → 2 : **−1**
2 → 12 : **−2** (December)
12 → P : **−3** ⇒ 12 − 3 = **9 (September)**
P → 5 : **−4** ⇒ 9 − 4 = **5 (May)**
5 → 12 : **−5** (December)
12 → Q : **−6** ⇒ 12 − 6 = **6 (June)**
Q → 11 : **−7** ⇒ 6 − 7 = −1 ⇒ **11 (November)**
Therefore:
P = September
Q = June
Subject:) CSAT
Topic:) Logical and Verbal Reasoning
Subtopic:)

Q.55) What is the remainder when 65^{99} is divided by 11?
a) 0
b) 5
c) 9
d) 10

Ans) d
Exp) Option d is the correct answer.
To determine the remainder when 65^{99} is divided by 11, we can use Fermat's Little Theorem. Fermat's Little Theorem states that if p is a prime number and a is an integer not divisible by p, then:
$a^{p-1} \equiv 1 \pmod p$
Here, p=11 and a= 65. First, we reduce 65 modulo 11
$65 \equiv 65 - (5 \times 11) = 65 - 55 = 10 \pmod{11}$
Calculate $10^{99} \pmod{11}$:
Using Fermat's Little Theorem: $10^{10} \equiv 1 \pmod{11}$
$10^{99} = 10^{10\times 9} \times 10^9 \equiv 1^9 \times 10^9 \equiv 10^9 \pmod{11}$
Simplify $10^9 \pmod{11}$:
$10 \equiv -1 \pmod{11} \rightarrow 10^9 \equiv (-1)9 \equiv -1 \pmod{11} \equiv 10 \pmod{11}$
So, **the remainder when 65^{99} is divided by 11 is: (d) 10**
Subject:) CSAT
Topic:) Quantitative Aptitude
Subtopic:)

Q.56) Two teams, A and B, played a certain number of matches against each other. Team A won exactly three-fourths of the matches played initially. Later, the teams played 7 additional matches, and team A lost all of these matches. After these additional games, it was observed that team A had won exactly two-thirds of the total matches played. How many matches did Team A initially win?

a) 21
b) 35
c) 42
d) 63

Ans) c

Exp) Option c is the correct answer.

Given:

• Initially, team **A won 3/4 of the matches**.
• Later, **7 more matches** were played and **team A lost all of them**.
• After these matches, team A's winning fraction became **2/3 of the total matches**.

We must find the **number of matches originally won by team A**.

Assume Total Initial Matches

Let Total matches initially played = **M**

Since team A won **3/4 of the matches**

Matches won by A initially = (3/4)M

After 7 Additional Matches

Team A **loses all 7 matches**.

Thus:

• Wins of A remain the same = **(3/4)M**
• Total matches become

M + 7

Use the Final Winning Fraction

After the additional matches:

Team A won **2/3 of all matches played**.

Thus (3/4)M / (M + 7) = 2/3

Solve the Equation

Multiply both sides by **(M + 7)**

(3/4)M = (2/3)(M + 7)

Multiply throughout by **12** to clear fractions

9M = 8(M + 7)

Expand

9M = 8M + 56

Thus M = 56

Matches Won Initially

Matches won by team A initially = (3/4) × 56 = 42

Therefore, Option c is the correct answer.

Subject:) CSAT

Topic:) Quantitative Aptitude

Subtopic:)

Directions for the following 4 (four) items:
Read the following three passages and answer the items that follow the passages. Your answers to these items should be based on the passages only

Passage - 1

Women often enter organisations carrying expectations shaped by years of socialisation, which can influence how they view leadership and their place within it. As a result, they may hesitate to articulate their ambitions or avoid taking visible risks. Women's leadership programmes can help address these challenges by creating spaces where participants can reflect on and challenge long-held beliefs and stereotypes about women in leadership positions. These programmes foster psychologically safe environments that enable deeper learning and genuine behavioural change. However, for such efforts to translate into meaningful progress, organisations must go beyond simply bringing women into the system and create environments where women are supported not only to enter the leadership pipeline but also to grow and remain within it.

Q.57) Which one of the following statements best reflects the most logical and rational inference that can be drawn from the passage?
a) Technical competence matters, but the right attitude is vital for becoming a leader.
b) Women often lack confidence in fully expressing themselves when stepping into leadership roles.
c) Without structural support, leadership programs alone cannot ensure women's advancement.
d) Leadership programs help counter socialization biases against women and create a foundation for their advancement.

Ans) c
Exp) Option c is the correct answer.
Statement a is incorrect. While the idea is mentioned in the passage, statement a does not best reflect the most logical and rational inference that can be drawn from the passage because it is a **general statement that does not specifically refer to women**.
Statement b is incorrect. The passage states "Women often enter organisations carrying expectations shaped by years of socialisation, which can influence how they view leadership and their place within it. As a result, they may hesitate to articulate their ambitions or avoid taking visible risks." However, statement a does not best reflect the most logical and rational inference that can be drawn from the passage as it **does not discuss what are the solutions to the above problem**.
Statement c is correct. It best reflects the most logical and rational inference that can be drawn from the passage as it comprehensively highlights that **while leadership programs can aid growth of women, they are not sufficient if organizations do not foster an environment conducive to the growth of women.**
Statement d is incorrect. While the statement is an important inference, it is narrower than option c as it **does not highlight that leadership programs alone are not sufficient for the growth of women.**
Subject:) CSAT
Topic:) Reading Comprehension
Subtopic:)

Q.58) With reference to the above passage, the following assumptions have been made:
I. Societal norms frequently undermine women's ability to assume leadership roles.
II. Leadership programs are necessary for unlocking the full potential of women.
Which of the above assumptions is/are valid?
a) I only
b) II only
c) Both I and II
d) Neither I nor II

Ans) a

Exp) Option a is the correct answer.

Statement I is correct. The passage states that there are certain **stereotypes against women in leadership roles**. Therefore, we can conclude that assumption made in statement I is correct.

Statement II is incorrect. While the passage states that leadership programs aid in unlocking the full potential of women, it **does not claim that leadership programs are necessary for women**. Therefore, assumption made in statement II is incorrect.

Subject:) CSAT

Topic:) Reading Comprehension

Subtopic:)

Passage - 2

To tackle the problem of pollution in cities, policy makers think that drastic actions like temporary use of odd-even number scheme for vehicles, closing schools, factories, construction activities, and banning the use of certain type of vehicles are a way forward. Even then the air is not clean. Vehicles more than 15 years old comprise one percent of the total; and taking them off the road will not make any difference. Banning certain fuels and car types arbitrarily is not proper. Diesel engines produce more PM 2.5 and less CO_2 than petrol or CNG engines. On the other hand, both diesel and CNG engines produce more NOx than petrol engines. No one has measured the amount of NOx that CNG engines are emitting. Arbitrary bans on vehicles that have passed mandated fitness tests and periodic pollution tests are unfair. What is needed is the scientific and reliable information about the source of pollutants on a continuing basis and the technologies that will work to reduce pollution form them.

Q.59) Which one of the following statements best reflects the most logical and rational implication conveyed by the passage?

a) Arbitrary curbs on vehicles to reduce pollution are difficult to implement.

b) Knee-jerk reactions cannot solve the problem of pollution but an evidence based approach will be more effective.

c) A heavy penalty should be enforced on those driving without periodic pollution tests.

d) In the absence of laws to deal with the problems of pollution, the administration tends to make arbitrary decisions.

Ans) b

Exp) Option b is the correct answer.

Option a is incorrect- This option is not supported by the passage. While the passage criticizes the arbitrary nature of some bans on vehicles, it doesn't specifically mention that implementing curbs on vehicles is difficult. The focus of the passage is more on the need for a scientific and reliable approach to tackle pollution.

Option b is correct- The **passage highlights that the current measures taken to tackle pollution, such as temporary oddeven schemes, closing schools and factories, and banning certain vehicles or fuels, have not resulted in clean air. It argues that these actions are drastic and arbitrary, without considering scientific evidence or reliable information about the sources of pollutants and the technologies that can effectively reduce pollution**. The passage emphasizes the need for a more systematic and evidence-based approach to address pollution. It suggests that relying on scientific and reliable information about the sources of pollutants on a continuing basis, as well as identifying the technologies that can effectively reduce pollution from them, is necessary.

Option c is incorrect- This option is not directly addressed in the passage. The passage discusses the unfairness of arbitrary bans on vehicles that have passed mandated fitness and pollution tests, but it doesn't mention the enforcement of heavy penalties on those driving without periodic pollution tests.

Option d is incorrect- This option is not explicitly mentioned in the passage. The passage discusses the arbitrary nature of certain bans and the need for a scientific approach, but it doesn't specifically mention the absence of laws or attribute arbitrary decisions to the administration.

Subject:) CSAT

Topic:) Reading Comprehension

Subtopic:)

Passage - 3

There was a time when being stuck meant slowing down. Answers had to be searched for in books, libraries, interviews, and research. The process could be frustrating, but it demanded engagement. One had to explore sources, connect ideas, challenge assumptions, and arrive at conclusions independently. Critical thinking was not an optional skill that could be outsourced. Today, however, AI can generate an instant answer, and tasks that once took hours now takes minutes. Quantitative productivity has undeniably improved, but speed comes with trade-offs. When answers are readily available, the need to wrestle with questions begins to fade, even though it is often in that very struggle that critical thinking is sharpened. The key, then, is to use AI thoughtfully, as a guide and a partner rather than a replacement, so that the mind remains engaged and the process of thinking itself is never lost.

Q.60) Which one of the following statements best reflects the crux of the passage?
a) Engaging in research through reading books cultivates critical thinking and enhances one's analytical skills.
b) Humans have outsourced their thinking to artificial intelligence, weakening their capacity for critical thought.
c) Artificial intelligence should serve as a tool for thinking and learning, not a replacement for them.
d) AI makes learning more efficient by enhancing productivity and delivering information instantly.

Ans) c
Exp) Option c is the correct answer.
Statement a is incorrect. While the idea is stated in the passage, statemen a does not best reflect the crux of the passage as it **highlights only one part of the passage that focuses on the era before AI.**
Statement b is incorrect. The passage emphasizes on the idea that using AI for every task could diminish the development of critical thinking, statemen b does not best reflect the crux of the passage as it **only highlights the problems of using AI.**
Statement c is correct. It best reflects the crux of the passage as it summarizes the passage. It highlights that **while AI makes learning efficient, it cannot replace the process of thinking.**
Statement d is incorrect. The passage states "AI can generate an instant answer, and tasks that once took hours now takes minutes." However, statement d does not best reflect the crux of the passage as it **only highlights the benefits of using AI.**
Subject:) CSAT
Topic:) Reading Comprehension
Subtopic:)